Case Studies

A selection of User Experience case studies

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Portfolio 2026

IT@LBG Forms

Creating a Better Form Experience

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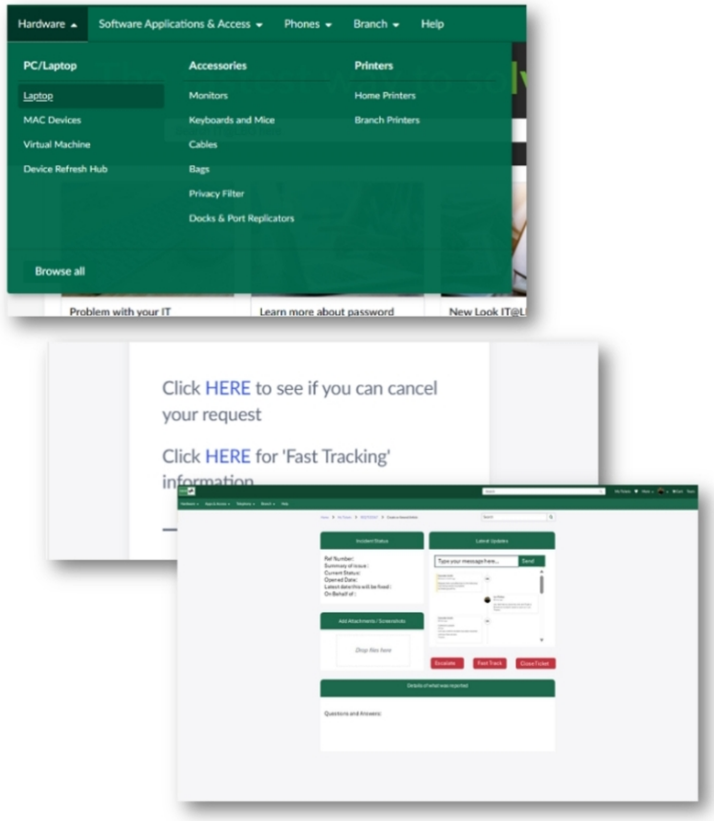
Executive Summary

IT@LBG contained forms and supporting journeys with recurring usability problems that made requesting IT products and services more difficult than necessary.

A heuristic audit identified issues across content, navigation and usability, aesthetics, interaction and layout. Examples included:

- **Technical and internal terminology such as “catalogue” and internal IDs.**
- **eCommerce language such as “Add to Cart”, “Checkout” and “Continue Shopping” being used for IT requests.**
- **Weak visual hierarchy and inconsistent spacing.**
- **Unclear completed, incomplete and pre-populated field states.**
- **Poor positioning of important actions such as attachments and submission.**
- **Questions and options that did not always clearly communicate what users needed to do.**
- **Limited validation and error prevention.**
- **Confirmation messaging and next steps that lacked prominence.**
- **Limited opportunities to review or amend information before submission.**



The challenge therefore went beyond fixing individual UI defects. There was an opportunity to understand why the same problems were appearing across different forms and journeys and establish a more consistent UX approach for designing IT forms.

Evaluated the existing experience

This began with a structured heuristic evaluation of existing IT@LBG experiences.

Each observation followed a consistent structure:
Journey/Page ⟶ Issue ⟶ Heuristic Principle ⟶ Recommendation

This enabled us to move beyond subjective design feedback. Instead of saying something "didn't feel right", **we could identify the usability principle being affected,** explain the potential impact on the user and propose an actionable improvement.

Findings were classified across five UX categories:

- Navigation & Usability
- Interaction
- Content
- Layout
- Aesthetics

- **Heurists Framework**
- **UX Audit (using heuristics)**
- **Present to Team & IT@LBG**
- **New Concept & Prototype**
  Co-creation session w/team & user testing
- **Benchmarking User Testing**
  (old vs. new)
- **Requirement Breakdown**
  Feasability & Limitations
- **Present to IT@LBG**

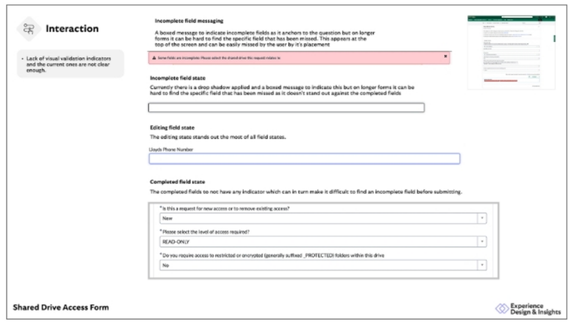
Core capabilities:

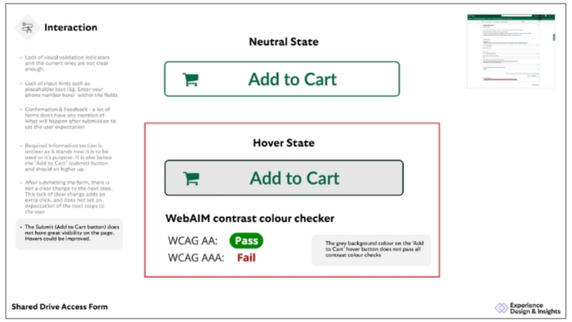
UX evaluation | Heuristic Analysis | Problem Definition | Evidence-led Design

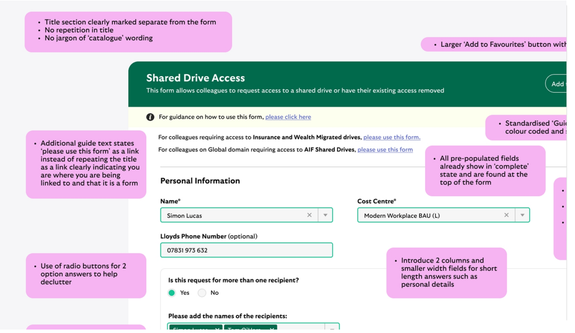
215

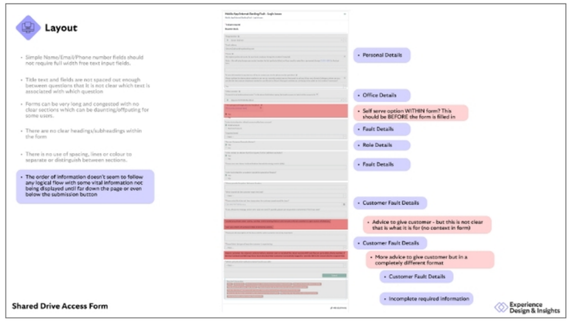
The audit identified 215 issues, with **Content** and **Navigation** & **Usability** representing the largest categories.

This created an evidence base that could be used to understand not simply individual problems, but patterns occurring across the wider IT experience.









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Turned individual issues into recurring UX patterns

I looked beyond individual screens to understand where similar usability problems were occurring across multiple journeys.

Core capabilities:

UX analysis | Pattern Identification | Systems Thinking | Interaction Design

Recurring themes included:

- **Lack of save-and-continue functionality.**
- **Inappropriate input types.**
- **Limited opportunity to review information before submission.**
- **Poor sequencing of actions.**
- **Unclear validation and field states.**
- **Inconsistent spacing and hierarchy.**
- **Technical or organisation-specific terminology.**
- **Inappropriate eCommerce language.**
- **Inconsistent introductory content.**
- **Weak grouping and ordering of questions.**

This was important because solving each issue independently could simply create another collection of inconsistent solutions.

Instead, the findings **helped us identify where reusable UX principles and interaction patterns** could address problems systematically.

Heuristic Principle	Total Issues	Percentage
Aesthetics	42	20%
Content	*57*	*27%*
Interaction	38	18%
Layout	29	13%
Navigation & Usability	49	23%

Researched best practice to establish a stronger approach

In collaboration with the team Service Designer, we complemented the internal audit by reviewing 18+ external toolkits, standards and frameworks relating to form design.

Core capabilities:

UX Research | Critical Thinking | Service Thinking | Problem Definition

The research highlighted a broader form design process:

Get the scope right → Structure the questions → Write understandable questions → Test with users → Publish and monitor

Explored approaches such as the Question Protocol, which challenged whether information needed to be collected in the first place.

Rather than immediately asking "How should we design this field?", this encouraged us to first ask:

"Why do we need to ask this question at all?"

That represented an important shift from designing individual UI components towards considering the underlying user need, business requirement and end-to-end journey.

Created 8 Good Form principles

Recurring themes included:

- **Ask only what you need.**
- **Use plain language.**
- **Group related questions and order them logically.**
- **Give context and set expectations.**
- **Prefer simple choices over free text.**
- **Provide help where it's needed.**
- **Prevent errors before they happen.**
- **Be consistent across journeys.**

This created a clear relationship between two parts of the UX process: **Heuristics diagnose usability problems → Good Form principles help design better experiences**

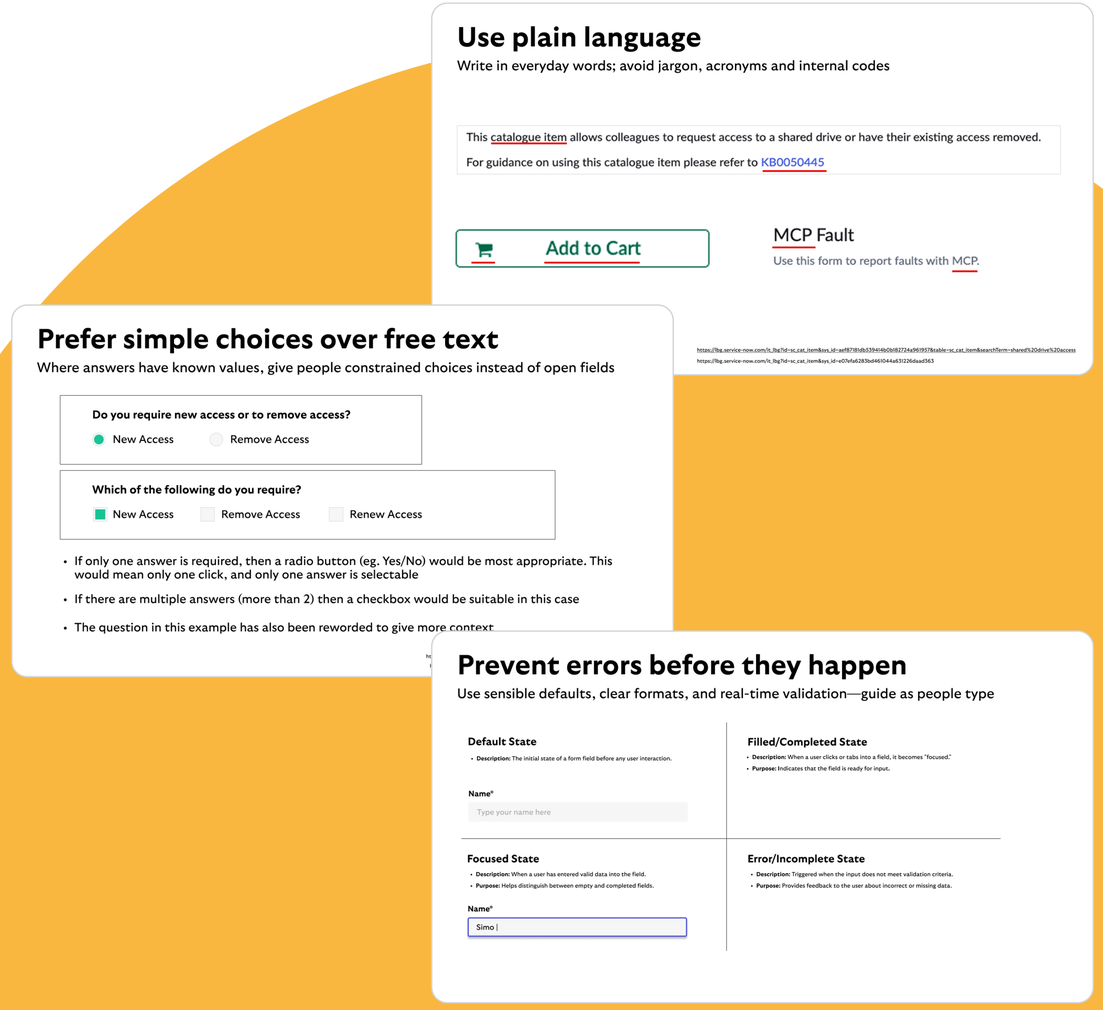
The principles also helped promote inclusive design.

Using plain language, providing contextual help, preventing errors and creating logical question sequences **reduces the amount of prior knowledge users need to successfully complete a journey.**

Rather than designing around users' understanding of internal IT processes, the aim was to design around the task they were trying to accomplish.

Core capabilities:

Inclusive Design | Content Design | UX Principles | Design Consistency



Applied the principles to an end-to-end journey

To demonstrate how the recommendations could work in practice, we applied them to the Ordering a Monitor journey.

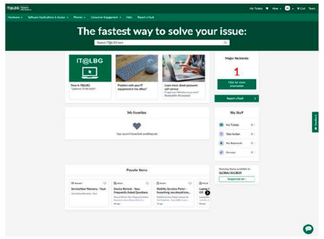
Rather than treating the form itself as the entire user experience, we considered the wider journey around it.

Core capabilities:

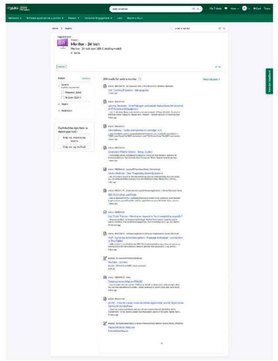
Journey Mapping | Information Architecture | Creative Problem Solving

The existing flow:

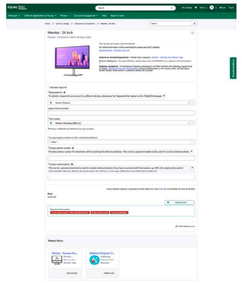
01 - Home page



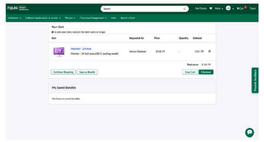
02 - Search and filtering



03 - Form

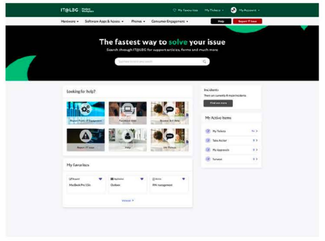


04 - Your Cart

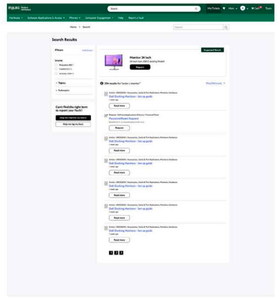


was reconsidered as:

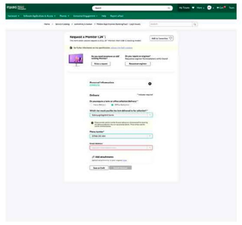
01 - Home



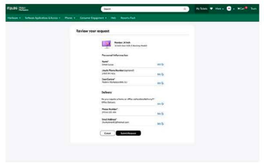
02 - Search & Filtering



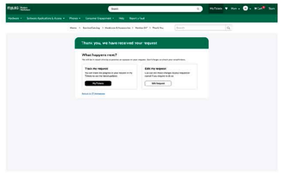
03 - Form



04 - Review your request
(replaces 'Your Cart')



*New**
05 - Thank You page



This allowed us to question whether traditional eCommerce patterns such as “Add to Cart” and “Checkout” accurately reflected the user’s mental model when making an internal IT request.

The work demonstrated the **value of considering journey flows before individual screens.** The objective was to create a clear progression from finding the service, through providing information, to reviewing a request and understanding what happens next.

Explored solutions through wireframing and prototyping

I used wireframing and prototyping to translate the Good Form principles into tangible design concepts.

Core capabilities:

Wireframing | Prototyping | Interaction Design | Journey Design

Rather than jumping directly to high-fidelity screens, concepts could be explored around:

Recurring themes included:

- **Question grouping and sequencing.**
- **Progress indication.**
- **Input selection.**
- **Save-as-draft functionality.**
- **Contextual guidance.**
- **Review-before-submission.**
- **Confirmation and next steps.**
- **Visual hierarchy.**
- **Completed, incomplete and error states.**

Wireframing allowed different approaches to be explored quickly and helped demonstrate how individual UX recommendations affected the whole journey rather than a single screen.

Prototyping then made those recommendations more tangible, allowing the proposed experience and interaction patterns to be communicated as a connected journey.

Figma

Mockups & Prototypes were created in Figma

maze

User Tests were created using Maze

These prototypes were taken in to Maze user testing (unmoderated) and moderated online user testing to compare against the original forms looking at usability, intuitiveness, ease of use.

The redesigned variant forms were tested against the original IT@LBG experience. Testing recorded **improvements In both usability and user satisfaction** across the redesigned experience.

Used consistent interaction patterns and Cancara

Consistency was an important part of the recommendations.

Rather than creating bespoke controls for individual forms, the design approach considered how established components and interaction patterns could be reused across journeys.

Cancara, the design system, provided the foundation for applying consistent organisational patterns and components when translating UX recommendations into interface designs. However, it should be noted that this was within the limitations of ServiceNow.

This helped connect the Good Form principles with a practical UI approach, supporting consistency across areas such as:

- **Input controls.**
- **Field states.**
- **Validation.**
- **Help and guidance.**
- **Actions and buttons.**
- **Page hierarchy.**
- **Review and confirmation.**

Core capabilities:

Design systems | Interaction Patterns | UI consistency | Scalable Design

> The aim was to **reduce unnecessary variation** so users wouldn't have to relearn how forms behaved as they moved between different IT requests.

Developed a repeatable UX process

The wider outcome was a repeatable form-design approach organised around three stages

Core capabilities:

UX process design | Design Strategy | Service Thinking | Continuous Improvement

Define the scope

Understand the user need, existing information, constraints and supporting processes.

Design the form

Structure questions and journey logic, challenge what information is needed, write clear content, prototype solutions and test the experience.

Build, publish & monitor

Implement the experience and continue monitoring opportunities for improvement.

The Question Protocol supported this process by challenging why information was required, who needed it, whether it could be obtained elsewhere and what happened if users could not provide it correctly.

This moved the work beyond recommendations for today's forms towards a **repeatable UX approach for creating better forms** in the future.

Result

The project delivered more than a list of individual usability problems.

A structured evidence base

The heuristic audit provided a consistent way of identifying UX issues and connecting them to usability principles and recommendations.

Greater visibility of systemic problems

Categorising findings revealed recurring patterns across IT@LBG rather than treating each form as an isolated design problem.

Eight reusable Good Form principles

Research and audit findings were translated into practical principles that could inform future form design.

A repeatable forms playbook

The work established a broader approach covering definition, design, prototyping, testing, publishing and monitoring, providing a framework for approaching future forms.

A tangible demonstration of user value

The concept for the Ordering a Monitor journey demonstrated how the principles could change a real end-to-end experience, moving away from technical and eCommerce conventions towards a journey centred on the task the user was trying to complete.

Ultimately, the value of the work was in **reducing cognitive effort, providing clearer guidance, preventing avoidable errors and creating more predictable journeys.**

It also demonstrated how UX could move beyond identifying individual usability defects and help establish reusable standards that improve experiences at scale.

> “I helped turn hundreds of individual usability findings into a repeatable UX approach for designing clearer, more consistent and inclusive IT forms.”

Audit
215 usability issues

Analyse
Identify recurring pain points

Research
18+ external standards and frameworks

Define
8 Good Form principles

Explore
Journey flows + wireframes

Design
Cancara + consistent interaction patterns

Prototype
End-to-end form experience, user testing

Demonstrate value
Clearer, more predictable IT request journeys

Device Refresh Hub

Improving colleagues device refresh journey

Steven
Gladman

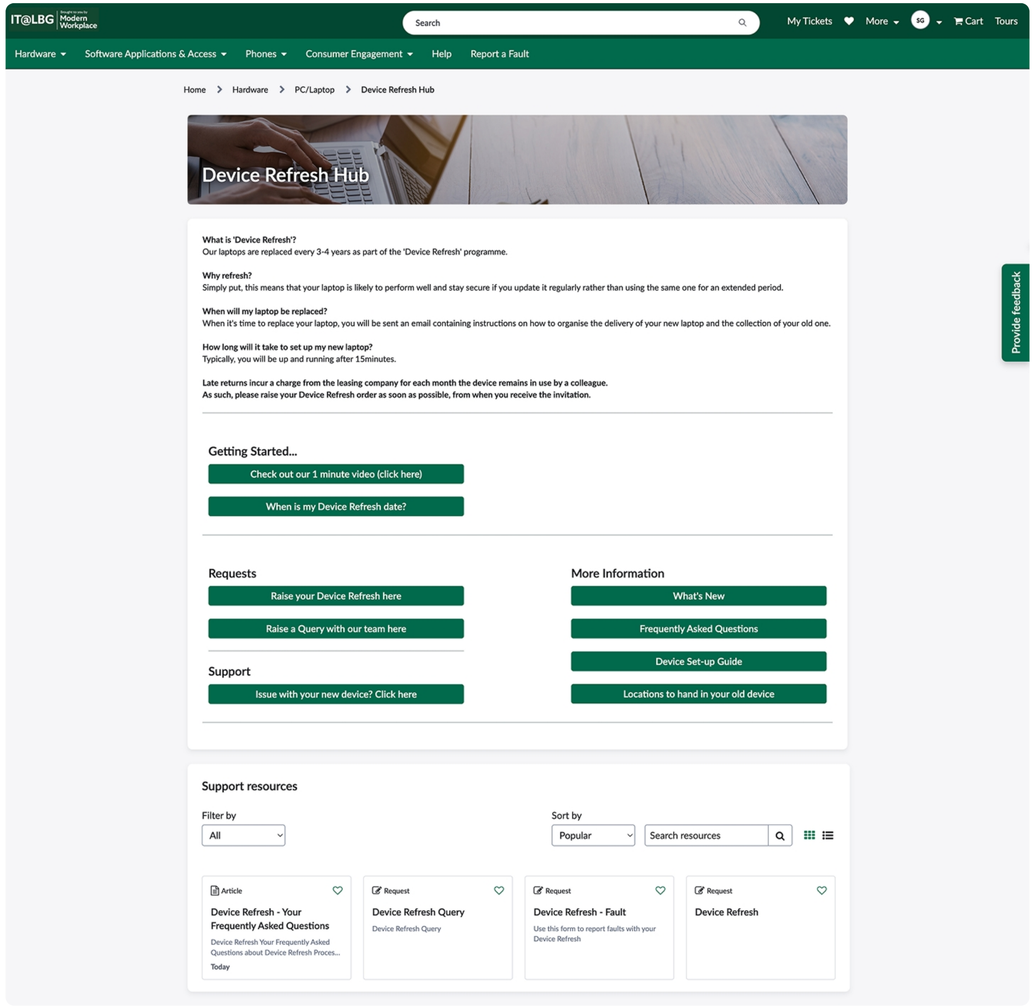
Executive Summary

The original Device Refresh Hub wasn't giving colleagues a clear or intuitive experience when navigating their device refresh.

A heuristic review with the team responsible for the Hub identified several usability issues:

- **Buttons lacked sufficient context, making it difficult to predict where they would take users.**
- **There was no clear journey through the page or clear expectation of what colleagues needed to do next.**
- **The experience didn't adequately reflect the different stages of a colleague's device refresh.**
- **Large amounts of information were presented together rather than prioritising what was relevant to the individual.**
- **Supporting content was sometimes disconnected from the journey.**

> The challenge was therefore bigger than redesigning a single page. There was an **opportunity to rethink how the experience could guide colleagues through their entire device refresh journey**, presenting the right information and actions at the right time.



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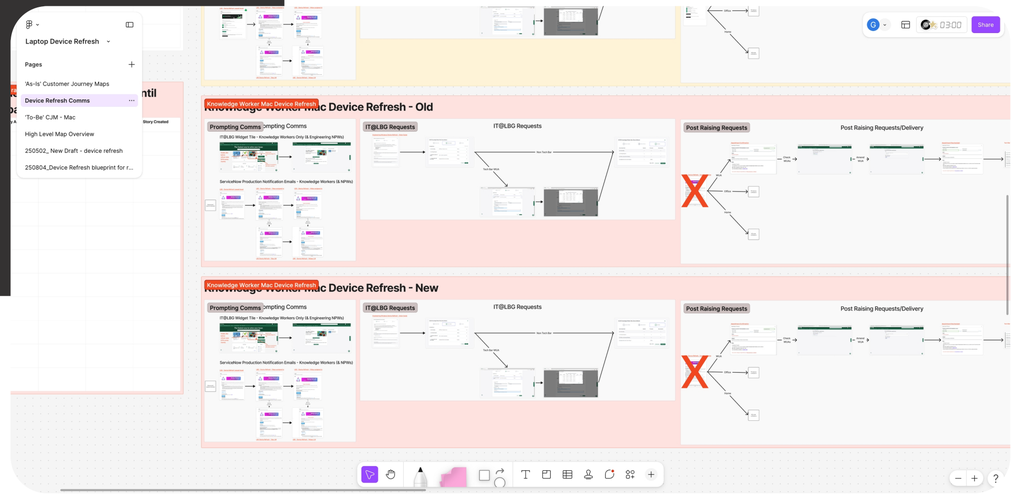
Objective

My objective was to create a simpler, clearer and more journey-focused Device Refresh experience, helping colleagues understand:

Where am I in the process? ⟶ What do I need to know? ⟶ What do I need to do? ⟶ What happens next?

As the UX designer, my role covered the process from evaluating the existing experience through to journey design, wireframing, prototyping and supporting implementation. My focus was to:

- **Identify and understand existing usability pain points.**
- **Define clearer journey flows around the device refresh process.**
- **Establish a stronger information hierarchy.**
- **Explore solutions through wireframing and prototyping.**
- **Use creative problem solving to simplify complex journeys and content.**
- **Establish clearer and more consistent interaction patterns.**
- **Use Cancara, the design system, to support familiar and consistent experiences.**
- **Promote inclusive design by reducing cognitive load and making content easier to understand.**
- **Consider the experience beyond the Hub itself, including associated forms, support pages and communications.**
- **Demonstrate value to users by helping colleagues more easily understand what they needed to do at each stage.**



Device Refresh Comms Map (Figjam)

Core capabilities:

UX analysis | Heuristic Evaluation | Problem Definition | Stakeholder Collaboration

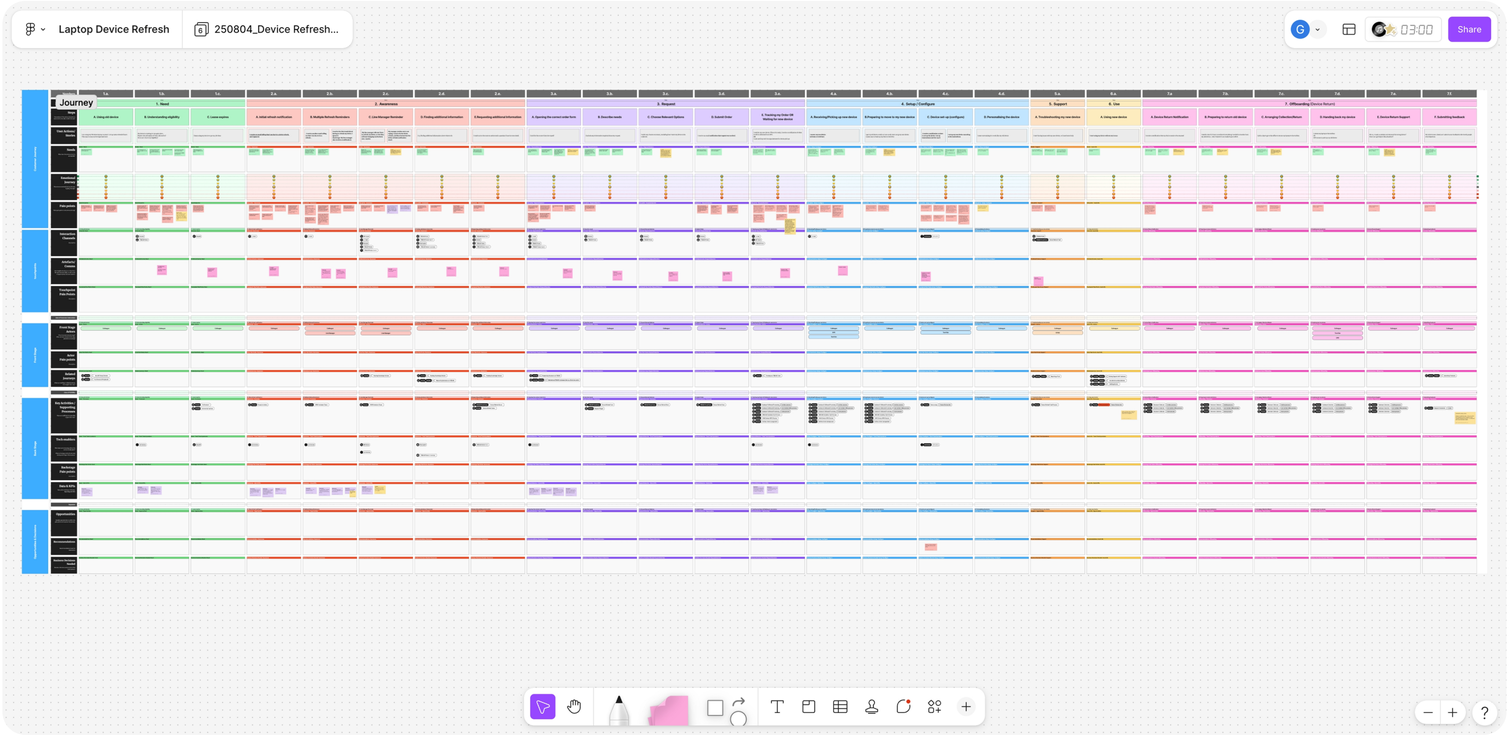
Evaluated the existing experience

I worked with the team responsible for the Hub to review the existing experience and identify usability problems around context, navigation, user flow and expectation-setting.

Rather than approaching the work as a visual redesign, I looked at the experience from the perspective of someone navigating their device refresh.

This helped establish a clearer problem statement: **the Hub needed to do more than provide information. It needed to actively guide colleagues through a process.**

The findings provided the foundation for subsequent design decisions and helped ensure that proposed changes could be traced back to a user problem.



Journey Map for Device Refresh (Figjam)

Core capabilities:

Journey Design | Information Architecture | Content Hierarchy | Problem Solving

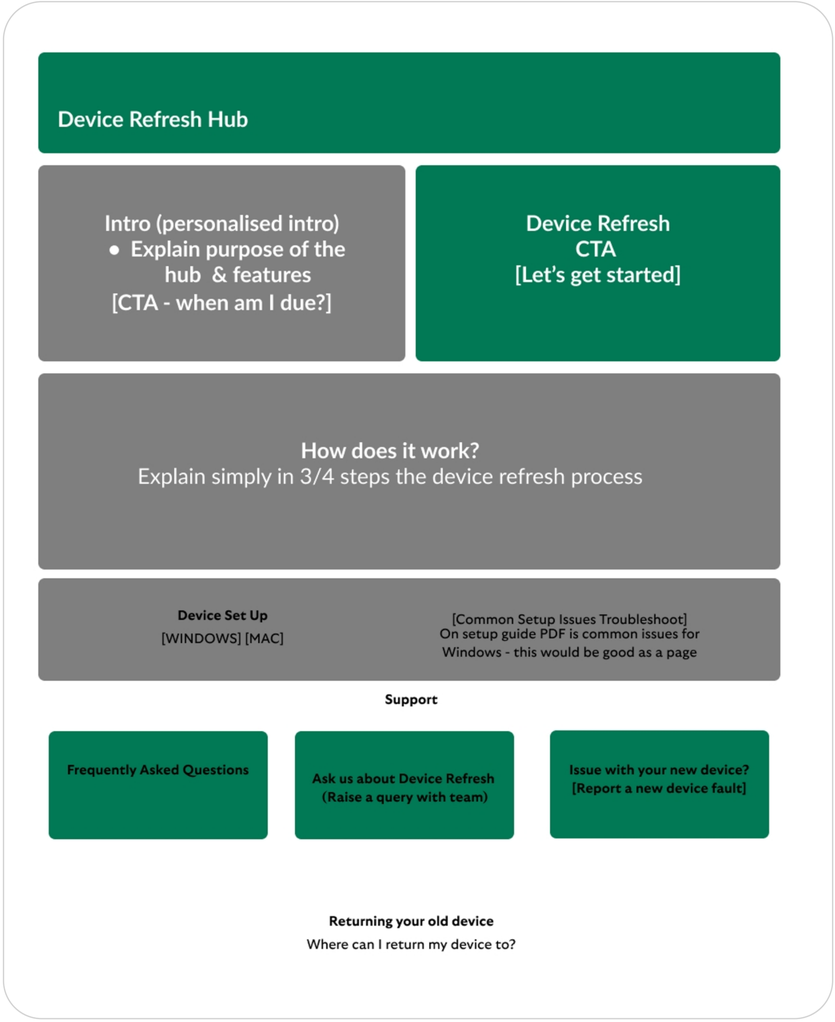
Mapped the journey and reconsidered the information architecture

I worked with the team to explore the hierarchy and relative importance of information across the Device Refresh journey.

A key design objective was to **reduce the amount of information competing for attention** on the Hub.

Rather than trying to accommodate everything within a single page, I considered the wider journey flow, using relevant existing pages where appropriate and proposing dedicated pages where content required more space or context.

This enabled the Hub to become more focused around **helping colleagues identify what was relevant to them a**nd where they should go next, rather than acting as a repository for everything related to device refresh.



An early wireframe considering the hierarchy of information on the page

Core capabilities:

Wireframing | Information Architecture | Iterative Design | Journey Flows

Explored solutions through wireframing

I translated the journey thinking into initial wireframes, exploring different ways of structuring and prioritising content before progressing into detailed UI design.

Wireframing allowed me to focus initially on:

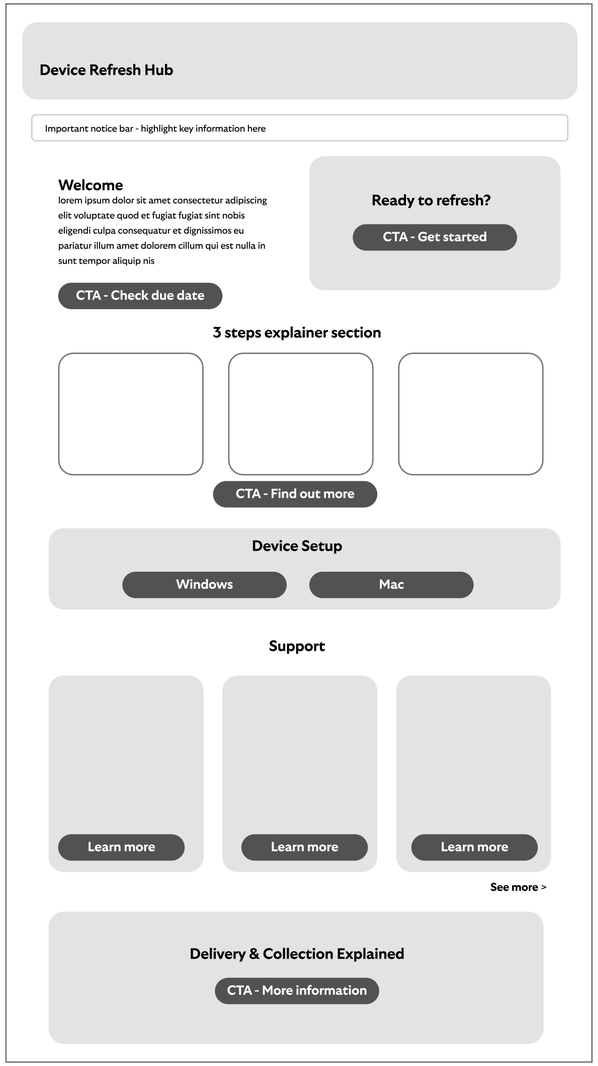
- **Page hierarchy.**
- **Content priority.**
- **Navigation.**
- **Calls to action.**
- **Journey progression.**
- **The relationship between Hub content and supporting pages.**

This allowed ideas to be explored quickly without prematurely committing to a polished UI.

The design process evolved from:

Understand → Map → Wireframe → Prototype → Refine → Build

This was important because the challenge wasn't simply deciding what the Hub should look like. It was determining **how the experience should behave around a colleague's needs.**



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Figma

Mockups & Prototypes were created in Figma

Core capabilities:

Personalised UX | Journey Design | Contextual Design | Creative Problem Solving

Designed around different stages of the refresh journey

A key piece of creative problem solving was exploring how the Hub could adapt to the colleague's current stage rather than providing everyone with the same static experience.

Three core journey states were defined:

Not Due → Now Due → In Progress

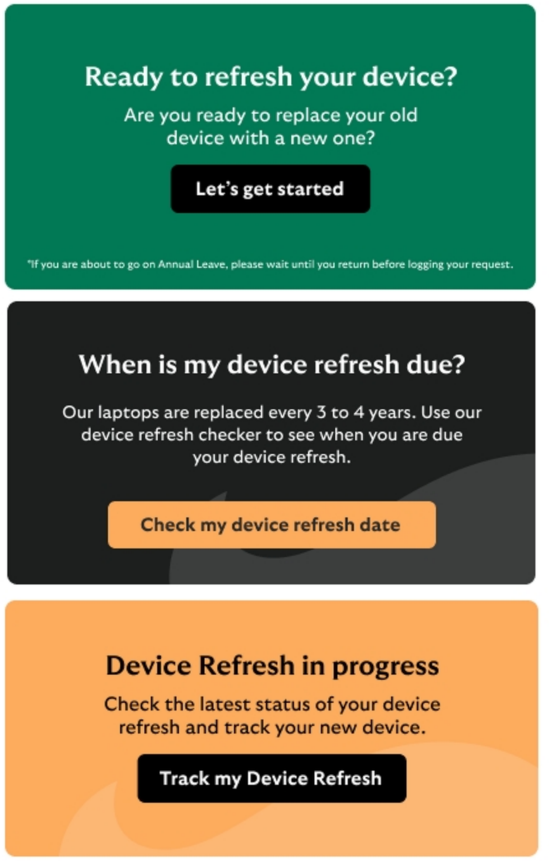
This allowed the design to consider how the hierarchy, information and actions could change according to where someone was within their refresh journey.

For example, someone who isn't yet due a refresh has fundamentally different needs from someone actively progressing through one.

The design therefore shifted away from:
"Here is everything you might need to know about device refresh."

towards:
"Here is what's relevant to you at this point in your refresh."

That helped create a more contextual experience and reduce the amount of information competing for users' attention.



Core capabilities:

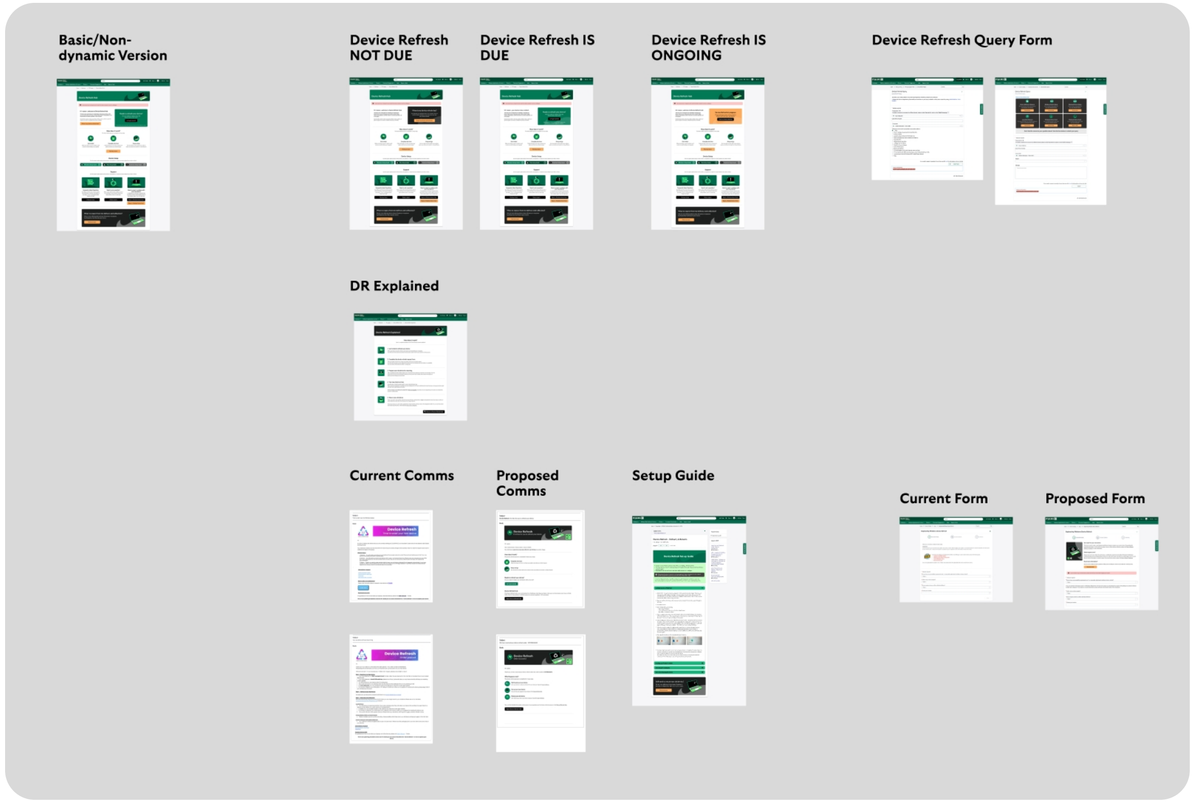
UI Design | Design Systems | Prototyping | Interaction Patterns

Developed the experience using Cancara

I progressed the wireframes into more detailed designs and prototypes in Figma, using the Cancara design system to support consistency with established organisational interaction and UI patterns.

Rather than introducing unnecessary bespoke components, Cancara provided a foundation for creating familiar patterns around elements such as navigation, calls to action and content presentation.

Using a design system also helped me consider consistency beyond the Hub itself. **As users moved between the Hub and supporting experiences, the objective was that the different parts continued to feel like one connected journey rather than separate products.**



Core capabilities:

Inclusive Design | Content Design | Cognitive Load Reduction | User-centred Design

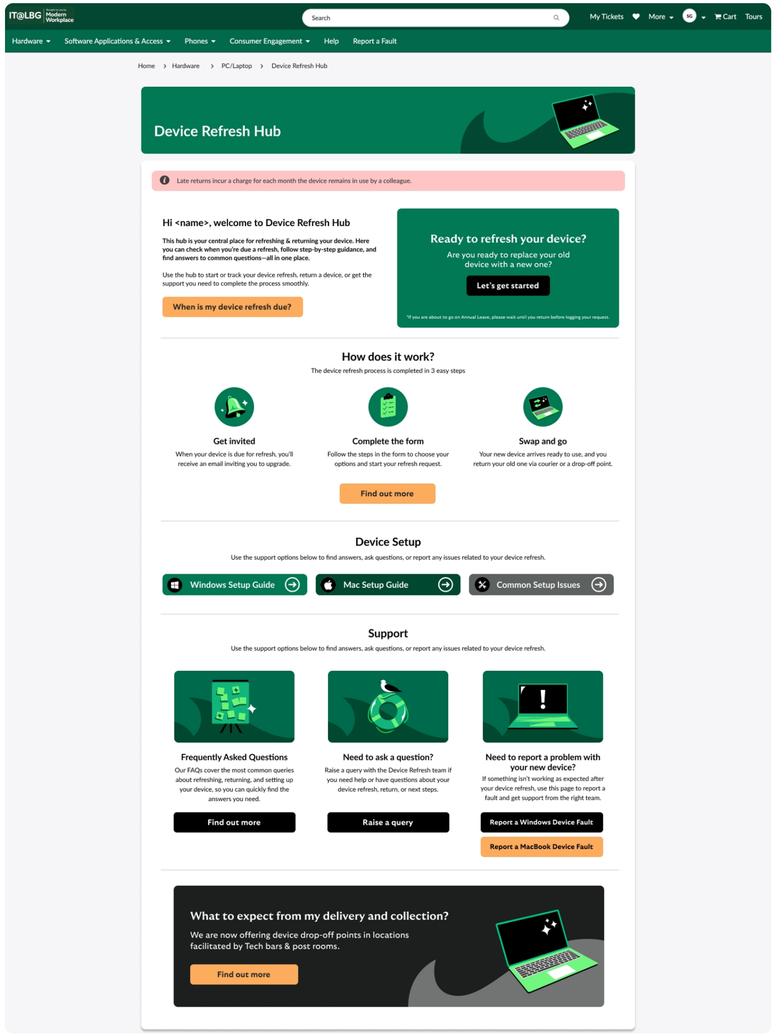
Considered inclusive design across the experience

Inclusive design was considered through both the structure of the journey and the way information was communicated.

The redesign focused on reducing unnecessary cognitive effort by:

- **Simplifying Content**
- **Establishing clearer hierarchy**
- **Giving actions greater context**
- **Reducing competing information**
- **Creating more predictable journey progression**
- **Keeping experiences consistent across pages**
- **Helping colleagues understand what they needed to do next.**

> The intention was to **reduce the amount of prior knowledge a colleague needed** to successfully navigate device refresh.
>
> Rather than expecting users to understand the underlying IT process, the experience could provide guidance around the task they were actually trying to accomplish.



Extended the design beyond the Hub

As the work developed, **I considered the broader end-to-end Device Refresh journey** rather than limiting the design to the Hub.

Associated pages and forms were reviewed to help ensure that information remained relevant, intuitive and consistent as colleagues progressed between different parts of the experience.

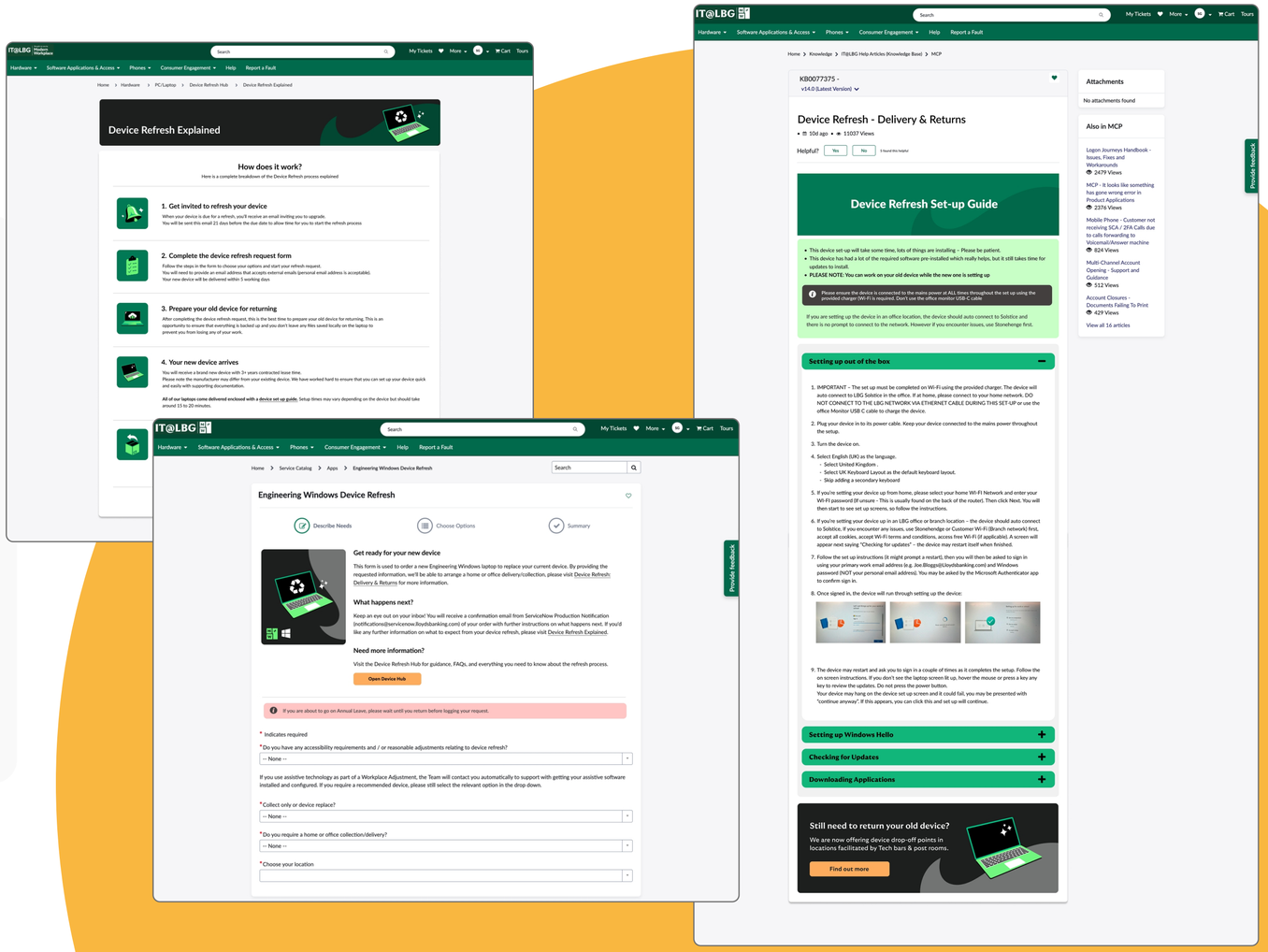
This was an important shift in the project.

Optimising the Hub alone wouldn't necessarily create a good user experience if the colleague subsequently entered a confusing form, received an overly complicated email or reached a page that felt disconnected from where they had come from.

The design therefore treated those touchpoints as parts of one connected user journey.

Core capabilities:

End-to-end journey design | Systems Thinking | Service Design



Simplified the Device Query journey

The Device Query experience presented a particular UX challenge.

There was a need to avoid unnecessary contacts while still making it straightforward for colleagues who genuinely required additional support.

I explored a progressive journey that presented **alternative guidance and frequently encountered queries first**, followed by a simpler contact form where further help was still required.

Core capabilities:

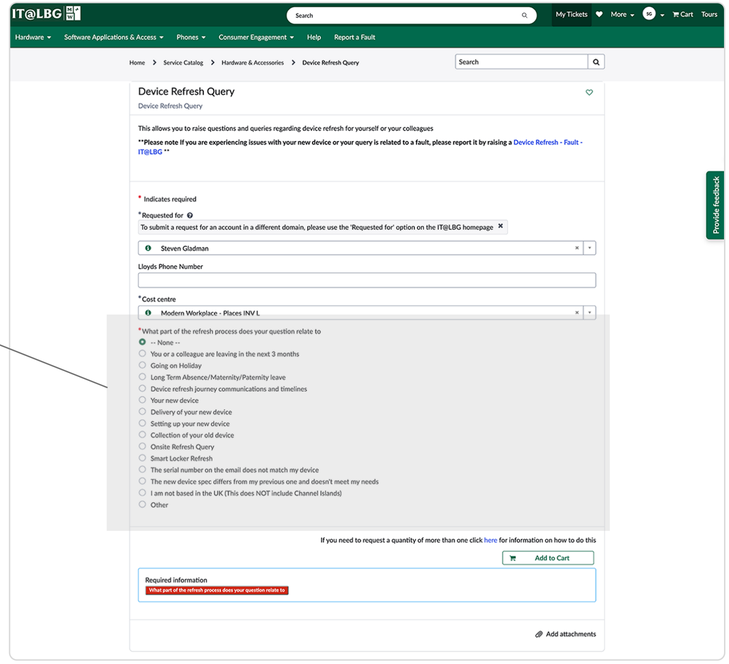
Creative Problem Solving | Form Design | Journey Optimisation

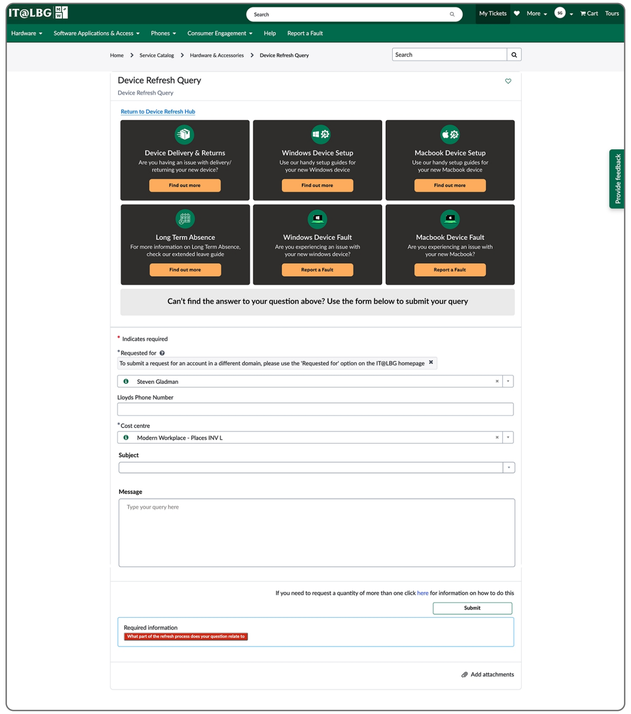
This balanced two needs:

Help colleagues self-serve where possible → Make it straightforward to ask for help when they can't.

The design therefore wasn't simply about shortening a form. It was about understanding **where the form should sit within the wider support journey.**

Radio button options displayed are not intuitive when providing guidance and didn't function as a query form failing to meet user expectations.





Alternative guides were added above the form to provide additional support before allowing the user to fill in a contact form to make their query.

This would give the user opportunity to troubleshoot before ultimately progressing to using the query form itself.

Redesigned supporting communications

Core capabilities:

Content Design | Omnichannel Journey Thinking | Cognitive Load Reduction

I also considered the communications surrounding device refresh.

The approach reduced and simplified email content, using communications to direct colleagues towards the Device Refresh Hub as the central place to understand their journey and find relevant information.

This helped prevent individual emails from attempting to explain every aspect of the process and **supported a more consistent relationship between communications and the digital journey.**

Subject

Your new device will soon be arriving

Body

Device Refresh
Order placed

Hi ,

Thank you! Your order for a new device has been placed – Your order number is RITM0010240.
Please keep this email handy, as it has your important set-up instructions for your new device.

What do I do next? – If you have placed a "Collect Only" request, please jump straight to step 3.

Step 1 – Receiving your New Device

- If you have selected an "**Walk-up Appointment**" simply collect the new device from the Tech Bar at the date/ time of your booked appointment.
- If you have selected a **Home/ Office delivery**, please turn off any junk email rules you may have set as this will stop you receiving courier updates.
- You will receive your new device within 5 working days.
- The courier will contact you advising when the new device will be delivered (this is not a phishing email)
- For **home deliveries**, you can change the date of the delivery by using the courier apps' website.
- On the day of delivery, you will be given a thr delivery timeframe to allow you to prepare for receiving the device, please keep hold of your old device at this point.

Step 2 – Setting up your New Device

The latest set-up instructions can be found here on our Device Refresh Set-up Guide.

Step 3 – Returning your Old Device

We have several drop off points across the UK where you can simply hand in your old device. Please see our for the latest Hardware Management SharePoint site locations.

Courier Return

- You will receive an external email from the courier, advising when they will collect your device (the wording may seem like it is a delivery as they deliver you a pink tote box for transportation).
- If needed, you can change the date of the collection by using the courier apps' website.
- On the day of collection, you will be given a thr collection time-frame to allow you to prepare for handing the device over.
- The courier will arrive with a plastic tote box. Please insert your old device, with its power supply, and they will take it away.

Onsite Refresh (Walk-up Appointments)

- Please complete your set-up the same day, where possible, and simply return your old device and power supply to the Tech-Bar.

Jersey/ Guernsey/ Isle based colleagues

- Your collection will be arranged locally as part of a bulk return. Please save the packaging from your new device and use to return your old one.

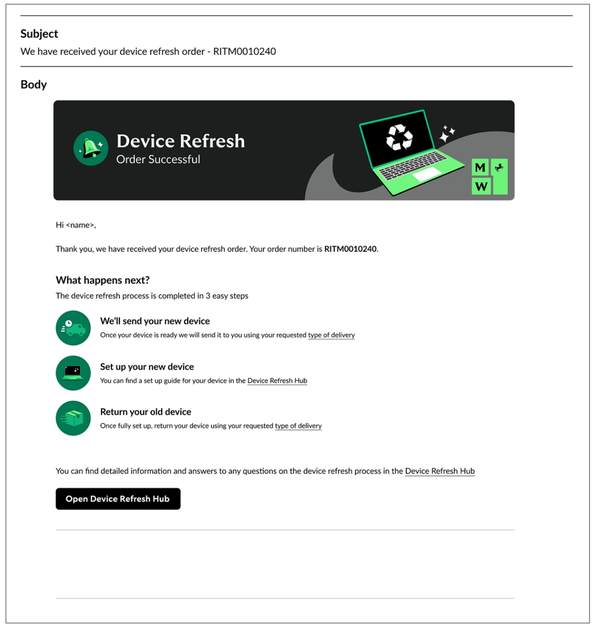
Information & Support

Device Refresh Hub Page
FAQ Page

Keeping Devices Safe

For guidance on how to look after your laptops, and other devices, please visit Safe & Secure – Thanks.

This is not a phishing simulation email, but if in doubt you can search SharePoint for "Device Refresh" on how to replace your device.


Subject

We have received your device refresh order - RITM0010240

Body

Device Refresh
Order Successful

Hi <name>,

Thank you, we have received your device refresh order. Your order number is **RITM0010240**.

What happens next?

The device refresh process is completed in 3 easy steps

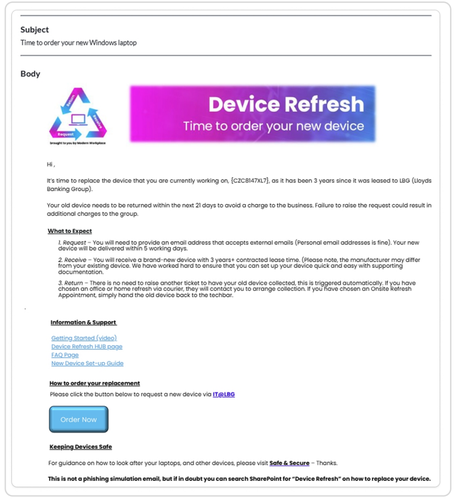
We'll send your new device
Once your device is ready we will send it to you using your requested type of delivery

Set up your new device
You can find a set up guide for your device in the Device Refresh Hub

Return your old device
Once fully set up, return your device using your requested type of delivery

You can find detailed information and answers to any questions on the device refresh process in the Device Refresh Hub

Open Device Refresh Hub


Subject

Time to order your new Windows laptop

Body

Device Refresh
Time to order your new device

Hi ,

It's time to replace the device that you are currently working on, [C2C8147KL7], as it has been 3 years since it was leased to LBG (Lloyds Banking Group).

Your old device needs to be returned within the next 21 days to avoid a charge to the business. Failure to raise the request could result in additional charges to the group.

What to Expect

1. *Request* – You will need to provide an email address that accepts external emails (Personal email addresses is fine). Your new device will be delivered within 5 working days.
2. *Receive* – You will receive a brand-new device with 3 years+ contracted lease time. (Please note, the manufacturer may differ from your existing device. We have worked hard to ensure that you can set up your device quick and easy with supporting documentation.
3. *Return* – There is no need to raise another ticket to have your old device collected, this is triggered automatically. If you have chosen an office or home refresh via courier, they will contact you to arrange collection. If you have chosen an Onsite Refresh Appointment, simply hand the old device back to the techbar.

Information & Support

Getting Started (video)
Device Refresh HUB page
FAQ Page
New Device Set-up Guide

How to order your replacement

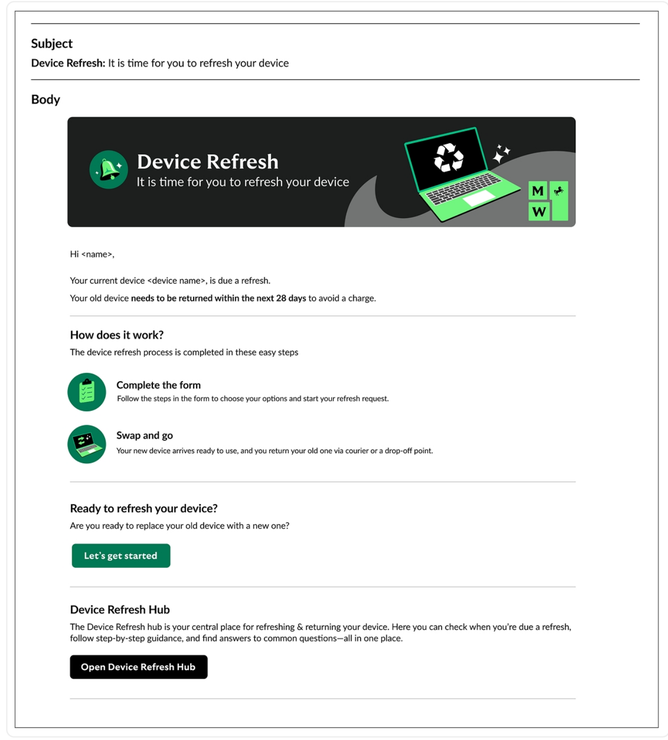
Please click the button below to request a new device via ITdsLBG

Order Now

Keeping Devices Safe

For guidance on how to look after your laptops, and other devices, please visit **Safe & Secure** – Thanks.

This is not a phishing simulation email, but if in doubt you can search SharePoint for "Device Refresh" on how to replace your device.


Subject

Device Refresh: It is time for you to refresh your device

Body

Device Refresh
It is time for you to refresh your device

Hi <name>,

Your current device <device name>, is due a refresh.

Your old device **needs to be returned within the next 28 days** to avoid a charge.

How does it work?

The device refresh process is completed in these easy steps

Complete the form
Follow the steps in the form to choose your options and start your refresh request.

Swap and go
Your new device arrives ready to use, and you return your old one via courier or a drop-off point.

Ready to refresh your device?

Are you ready to replace your old device with a new one?

Let's get started

Device Refresh Hub

The Device Refresh hub is your central place for refreshing & returning your device. Here you can check when you're due a refresh, follow step-by-step guidance, and find answers to common questions—all in one place.

Open Device Refresh Hub

Result

The project resulted in a redesigned Device Refresh experience that extended beyond a single Hub page.

A journey-led Hub

The new information architecture centred the experience around the colleague's refresh journey rather than presenting large amounts of information simultaneously.

Contextual journey states

The **Not Due, Now Due** and **In Progress** states provided the basis for an experience that could respond to where colleagues were within their refresh.

Consistency through Cancara

Using the Cancara design system helped support more familiar and consistent UI and interaction patterns throughout the redesigned experience.

A more connected experience

The work expanded across supporting pages, forms and communications, helping establish a more consistent end-to-end experience.

Simplified support journeys

The Device Query approach sought to help colleagues find answers before contacting support while keeping a clearer route available when additional help was needed.

Clearer value for colleagues

Fundamentally, the redesign moved the experience away from:
"Here is everything about Device Refresh."

towards:
"Here is where you are, what you need to know and what you need to do next."

> **“I transformed the Device Refresh Hub from a static information-heavy page into a journey-led experience designed around where colleagues were in their device refresh.”**

- **Evaluate**
  Identify usability pain points
- **Understand**
  Map the refresh journey and user needs
- **Structure**
  Reconsider hierarchy and content
- **Explore**
  8 Good Form principles
- **Explore**
  Wireframes + creative problem solving
- **Design**
  Cancara + consistent interaction patterns
- **Prototype**
  Connect the end-to-end experience
- **Extend**
  Forms + support + communications
- **Deliver**
  Collaborate through implementation

UK Debt Expert

Improving the quality of lead conversion

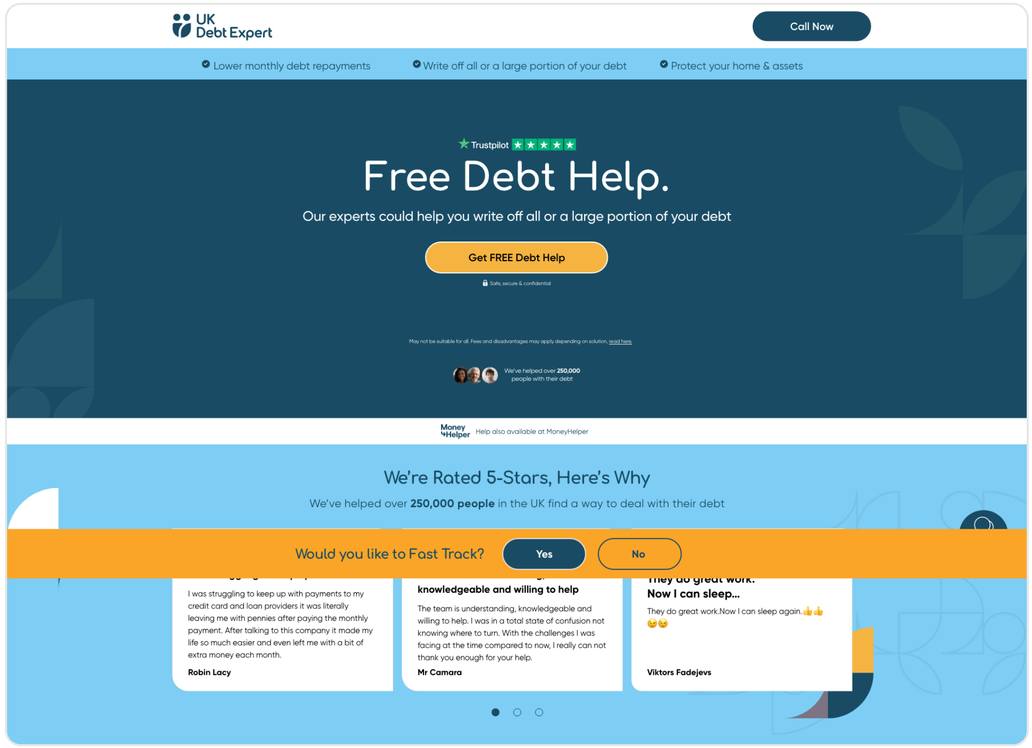
SITUATION

Executive Summary

UK Debt Expert's acquisition funnel saw its biggest drop-off when users were asked for their personal contact details, and there was only one route to debt help regardless of how urgently someone needed it.

Research into our existing users identified two broad types of customer:

- **Users with manageable debt who wanted time to research and understand their options.**
- **Users with more urgent needs, actively seeking debt advice and more likely to want to talk.**
- **Both were sent down the same funnel, with no clear pathway for higher-intent users.**
- **Information collected online was then asked again on the call, adding time for users and the call centre.**



Landing page with the Fast Track sticky banner (desktop)

The challenge was therefore bigger than fixing a single drop-off point. There was an opportunity to **design experiences around different levels of urgency and intent**, improving not just the number of leads but their quality.

TASK

Objective

My objective was to understand why users abandoned the funnel and improve conversion by creating journeys better suited to each type of user:

Who are our users? → What do they need? → How urgently? → What's the right journey for them?

As the designer, my role covered user research, analysis, concept design, wireframing, prototyping and testing. My focus was to:

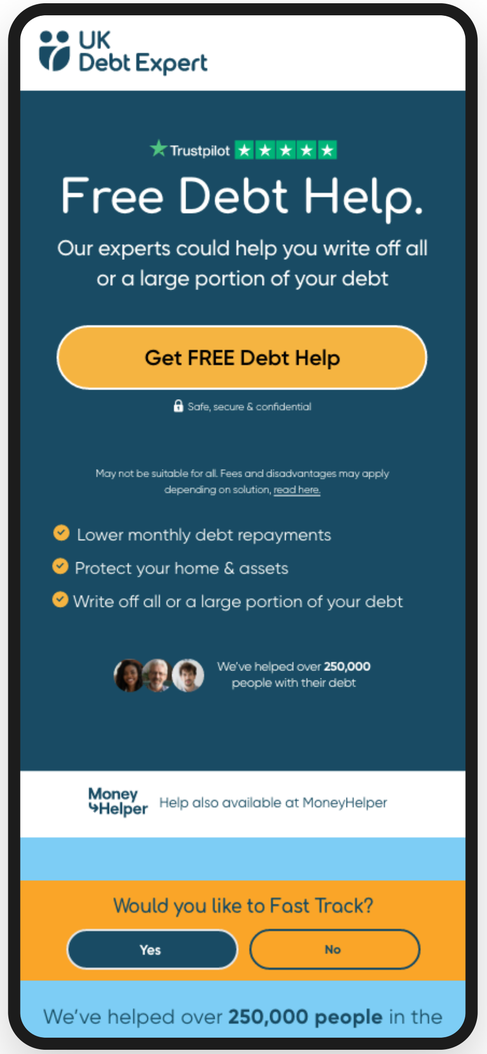
- Understand who our users were through demographic research and surveys.
- Identify where and why users were dropping out of the funnel.
- Create a dedicated pathway for higher-intent users who wanted help sooner.
- Support research-led users with content that guided them to the right solution.
- Test entry points, messaging and funnel variants to find what worked best.
- Use behavioural analytics to identify friction and iterate on the evidence.
- Improve lead quality, not just volume, for the call centre team.
- Consider the full journey, including the hand-off to the call centre.

Design tools

Initially **Adobe XD**, with **Creative Suite** supporting design elements. **Figma** was later rolled out as the main tool for wireframes, mockups and prototypes.

Research & testing

User surveys and demographic analysis, **A/B testing** of entry points and messaging, and **FullStory** for behavioural analysis.



Landing page (mobile)

Core capabilities:

User Research | Surveys | Audience Segmentation | Problem Definition

ACTION

Researched who our users were

We started by breaking down our existing users by demographics, then ran user surveys to build a better understanding of who they were and what they needed.

Two distinct types of user emerged. They had different levels of urgency, confidence and readiness to engage.

This changed the question from "How do we get more leads?" to "What does each type of user need from us?"

Research-led

"I want to understand my options first."

Users with some debt that felt manageable. Comfortable taking time to research and understand which solutions were available to them.

- Lower urgency
- Information-seeking
- Needs reassurance and education

High intent

"I need help now."

Users with more urgent needs, looking for debt advice sooner and more likely to engage and want to talk to someone.

- Higher urgency
- More likely to convert
- No clear pathway other than the regular funnel

Core capabilities:

Content Strategy | SEO | User Intent | Contextual Advertising

ACTION

Supported research-led users with specialist content

For users who wanted time to understand their options, pushing them straight into an enquiry form wasn't the right answer.

Instead, we built **long-form, SEO-focused content** aimed at people with very specific types of debt, answering the questions they were already searching for.

These pages carried **in-context adverts alongside specialist keyword advice**, guiding readers towards the debt solution most relevant to their situation once they were ready.

The research-led journey

Search
A specific question about their type of debt

→

Specialist content
Long-form advice matched to the keyword

→

In-context ad
A relevant debt solution, when they're ready

Sustained growth

The long-form SEO strategy delivered sustained month-on-month traffic growth, building a steady stream of better-informed users.

Core capabilities:

Concept Design | Journey Design | Form Design | Service Thinking

ACTION

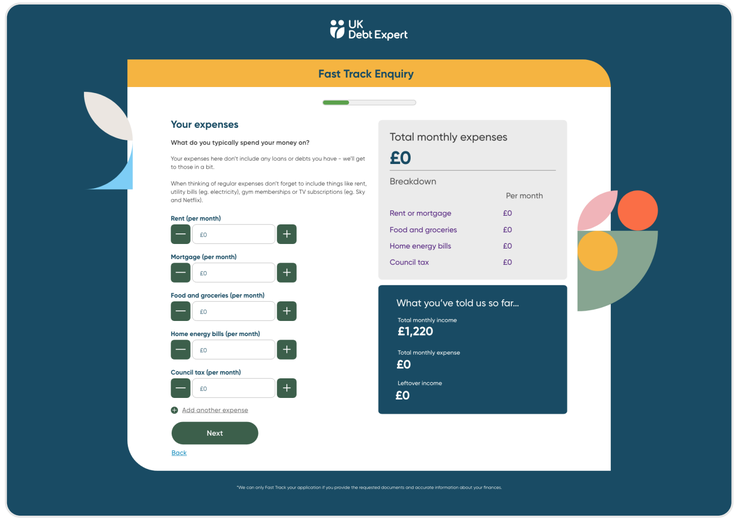
Created a Fast Track journey for high-intent users

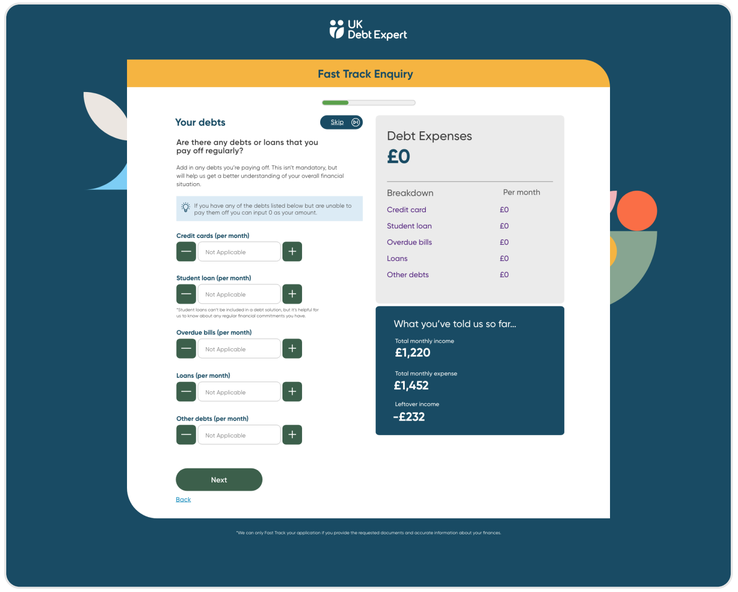
We knew higher-intent users were more likely to convert, but there was no clear pathway for them. **Fast Track was a concept I wanted to create to fill that gap.**

The Fast Track funnel asked the same questions as the regular funnel, then added extra steps where users could enter their **income, expenses and debts** and **upload their latest bank statements**.

These were questions normally asked on the call. Answering them upfront **saved time for users and the call centre** and gave a smoother process for both.

A running “What you’ve told us so far…” summary helped users see their finances come together as they progressed.





Fast Track Enquiry: expenses and debts steps (desktop)

Core capabilities:

A/B Testing | Interaction Design | Behavioural Insight | Experimentation

ACTION

Tested how users would enter Fast Track

The first round of testing looked at where and how to start the Fast Track funnel. A sticky banner stayed at the bottom of the screen on mobile and desktop. We tested a **Yes/No** version against a single button, because we were concerned that users might dismiss it the way they would a cookie accept/reject banner.

OPTION A

Two buttons in the hero

Fast Track presented as a second, parallel call to action.

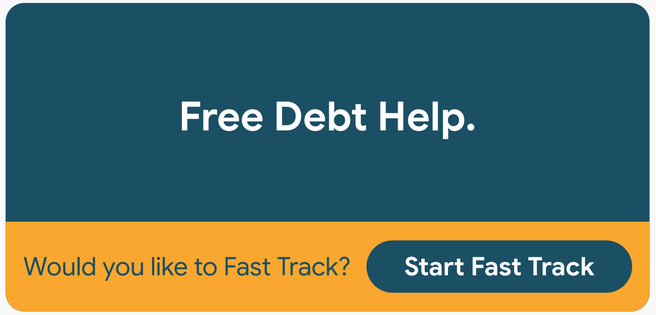
OPTION B

Sticky banner: Yes / No

Asks the question directly. Would users reflexively hit “No”?

OPTION C

Sticky banner: single button



A single route straight into Fast Track, with no explicit “No”.

Simplified illustration of the entry-point variants

Steven Gladman

Core capabilities:

A/B Testing | Funnel Design | Conversion Optimisation | Lead Quality

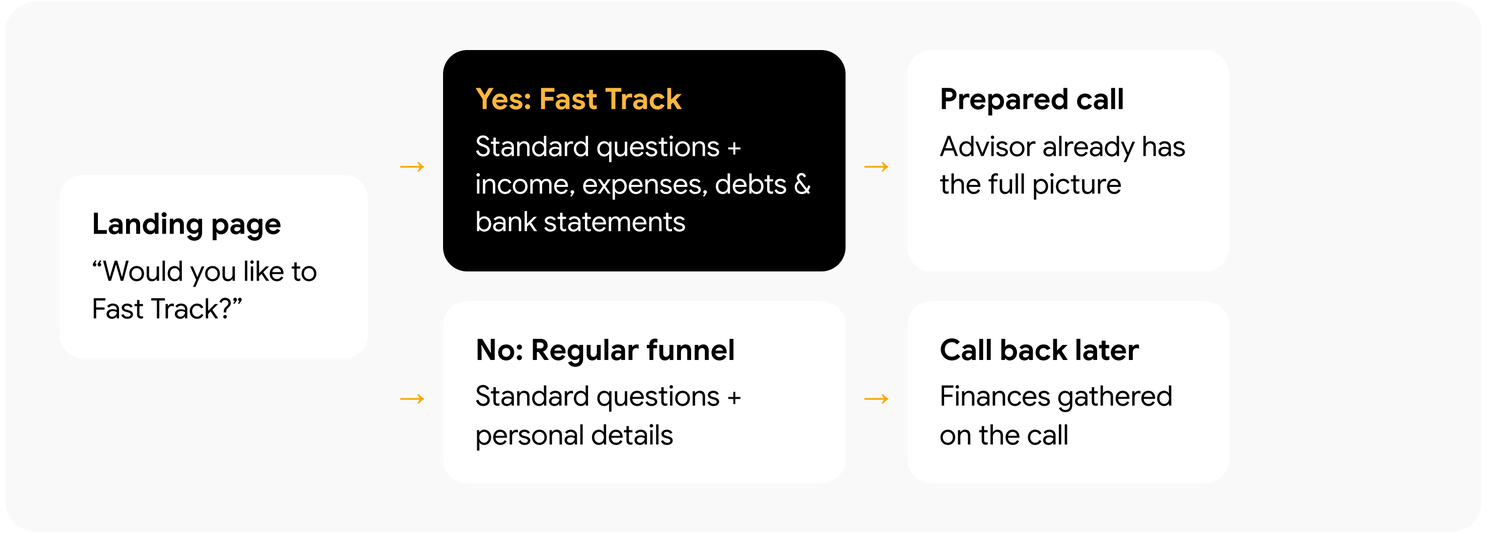
ACTION

Tested Fast Track against the regular funnel

Users choosing **Yes** entered the Fast Track funnel. Users choosing **No** went through the regular funnel, entered their personal details and received a call back later.

We saw a **huge uptake in users wanting to Fast Track**, with **improved conversion** compared with the original funnel.

Giving high-intent users a way to show that intent, and act on it, made a measurable difference.



Outcome Higher uptake and improved conversion, with more of the information the call centre needed captured before the first conversation.

Core capabilities:

Behavioural Analytics | FullStory | Funnel Analysis | Mobile UX

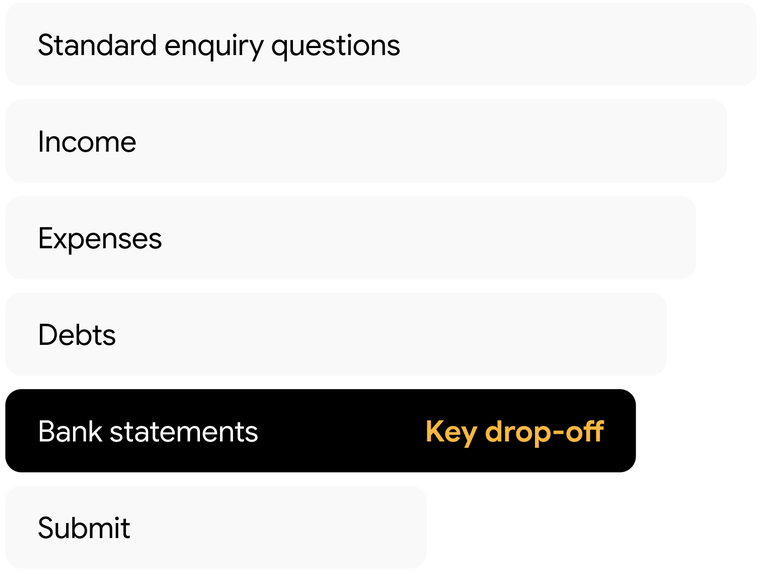
ACTION

Used FullStory to find where users dropped off

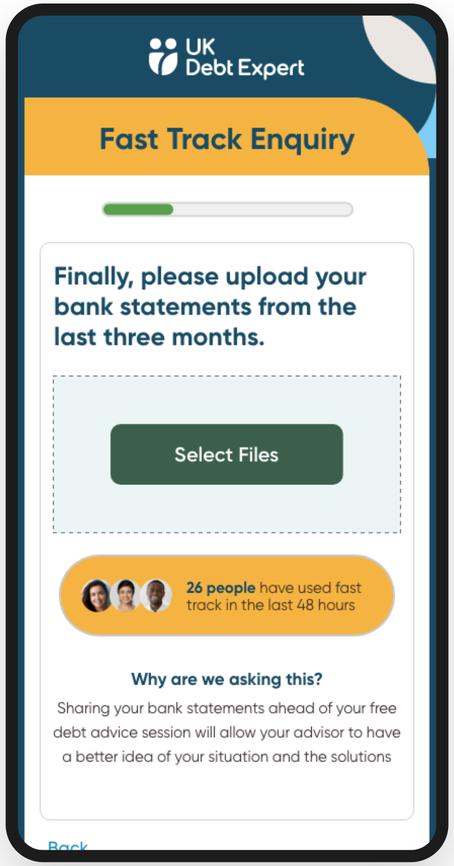
I used FullStory to get a full breakdown of how far users were getting through the Fast Track funnel, along with wider interaction behaviour.

One of the biggest drop-offs was on the **bank statement upload step**, particularly **on mobile**.

Users often didn't have their statements to hand, and rather than leave and come back, **they gave up at this point.**



Simplified view of the Fast Track steps



Bank statement upload (mobile)

Core capabilities:

Evidence-led Design | Iteration | Cross-device Journeys | Re-engagement

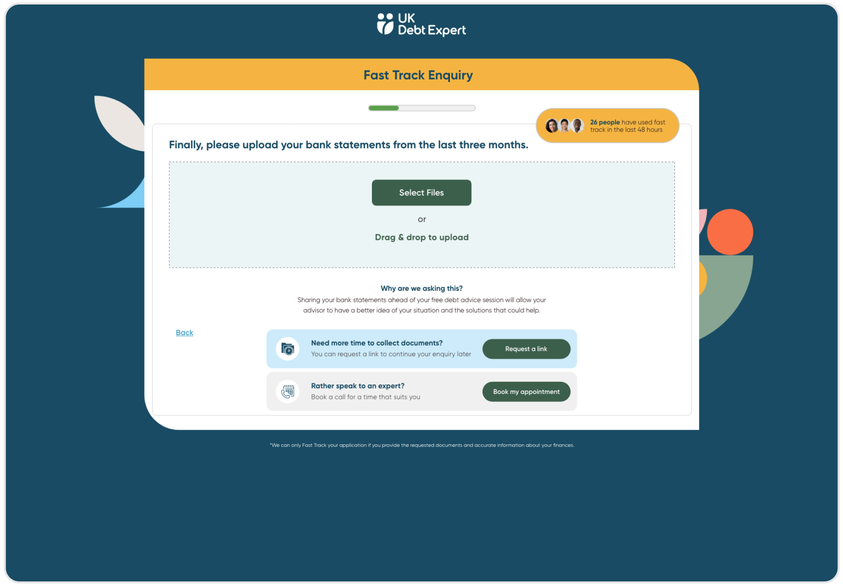
ACTION

Introduced Save progress to recover abandonment

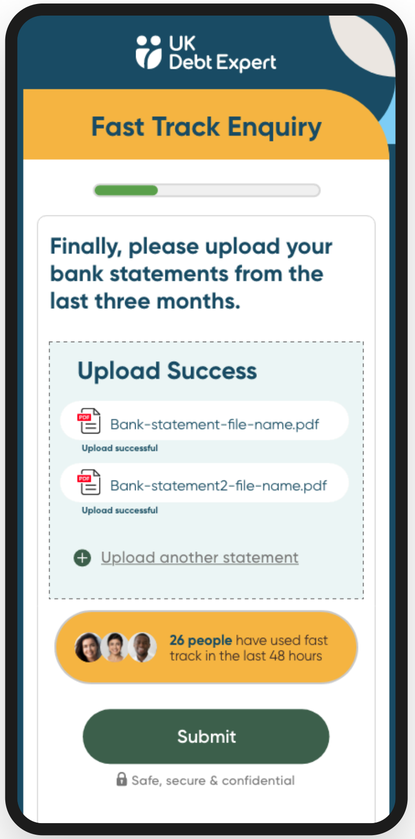
Based on this evidence, we created an updated variant with a **“Need more time to collect documents?”** option. Users could save their progress and receive an email link to continue later. This mattered for two reasons:

- **We had their email address and consent to contact them**, so we could encourage them to finish in their own time.
- **Users who struggled on their phone could continue on a desktop computer.**

We also offered the option to **book an appointment** instead. It got some click-throughs, but less engagement than continuing and uploading statements.



Save progress & booking options (desktop)



Upload success (mobile)

Steven Gladman

Core capabilities:

Service Design | End-to-end Journeys | Stakeholder Collaboration | Problem Solving

ACTION

Troubleshooting: aligning the full journey

A new type of lead needed the call centre to be ready for it. Call handlers had to be well equipped, and **everything the user had provided needed to be visible to them**.

In the first test of the concept, some call handlers were **asking questions users had already answered**. That caused more frustration than it saved.

The cause was a **Salesforce** issue: not all of the Fast Track data was reaching the handler's view. This was fixed in the early stages.

Where the journey broke

User	→	**Salesforce**	→	**Call handler**	→	**User**
Completes Fast Track		Not all answers visible		Repeats the questions		Frustrated

The lesson

A better form alone doesn't make a better experience. It showed how important it is to look at the **full journey flow and every touchpoint**, online and offline, to give users a consistent experience.

Result

The work created a more targeted funnel, designed around users' different levels of urgency, confidence and information needs.

A pathway for high-intent users

Fast Track gave users who wanted help sooner a clear route, with a huge uptake compared with the regular funnel.

Higher-quality leads

Fast Track brought in a high number of quality leads from users looking for more urgent help, with higher engagement.

Recovered abandonment

Save progress turned a key drop-off into a re-engagement opportunity, with email consent and a cross-device route to finish.

Sustained organic growth

Long-form SEO content delivered month-on-month traffic growth from research-led users.

Smoother call-centre hand-off

Capturing finances and statements upfront saved time on calls, once Salesforce showed handlers the full picture.

A culture of testing

Entry points, messaging and funnel variants were all tested, so each decision was based on evidence.

Looking ahead: Open Banking

When the new funnel rolled out, the company was in early talks about Open Banking. As people grow more trusting of it, it could replace manual statement uploads, removing the biggest drop-off point, speeding up the process and getting users the debt help they need sooner.

Core capabilities:

Experimentation | Variant Testing | Re-engagement | Continuous Improvement

FURTHER EXPERIMENTATION

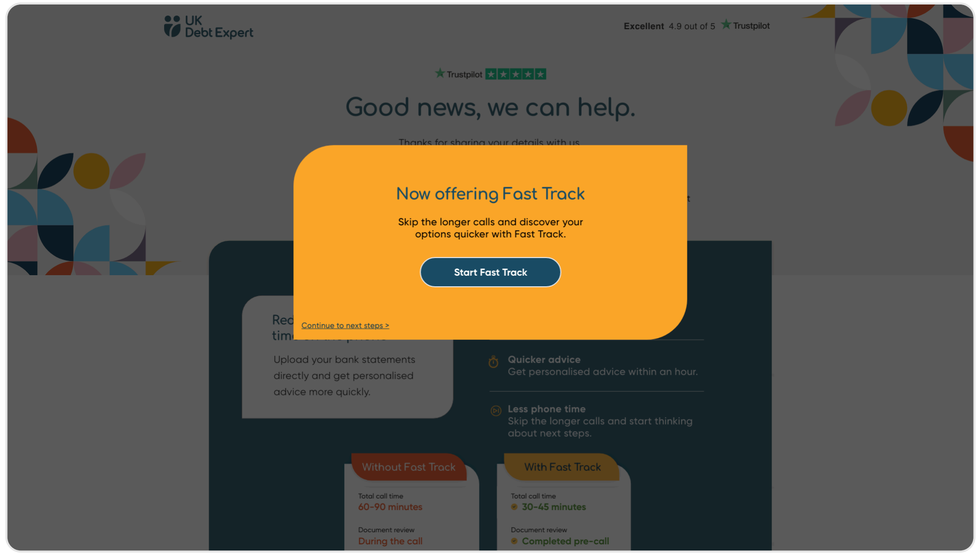
Further experimentation & testing

Once the Fast Track funnel was established, we started experimenting with **variants of the concept** to reach users who hadn't chosen it at the start.

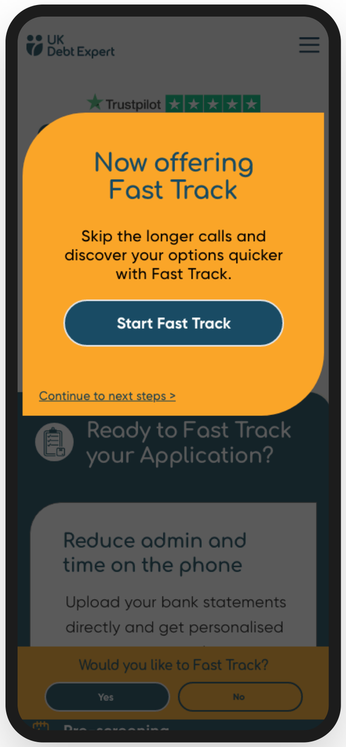
One variant was a **pop-up on the thank-you page**, shown to users who had just completed the regular funnel. Selecting **"Start Fast Track"** took them through the additional Fast Track questions, building on the answers they had already given.

The page behind it set out the benefits, such as **shorter calls** and **documents reviewed before the call**.

It **didn't perform as well as the full Fast Track funnel**, but it gave users another opportunity, and **a small number of users took it up**.



Thank-you page pop-up after the regular funnel (desktop)



Same pop-up (mobile)

“I helped turn a one-size-fits-all funnel into journeys designed around users’ urgency and intent, bringing in higher-quality leads.”

Research
Demographics + user surveys

Segment
Research-led vs. high-intent users

Content
Long-form SEO + in-context ads

Concept
Fast Track enquiry funnel

Test
Entry points + Fast Track vs. regular funnel

Analyse
FullStory drop-off analysis

Iterate
Save progress + book an appointment

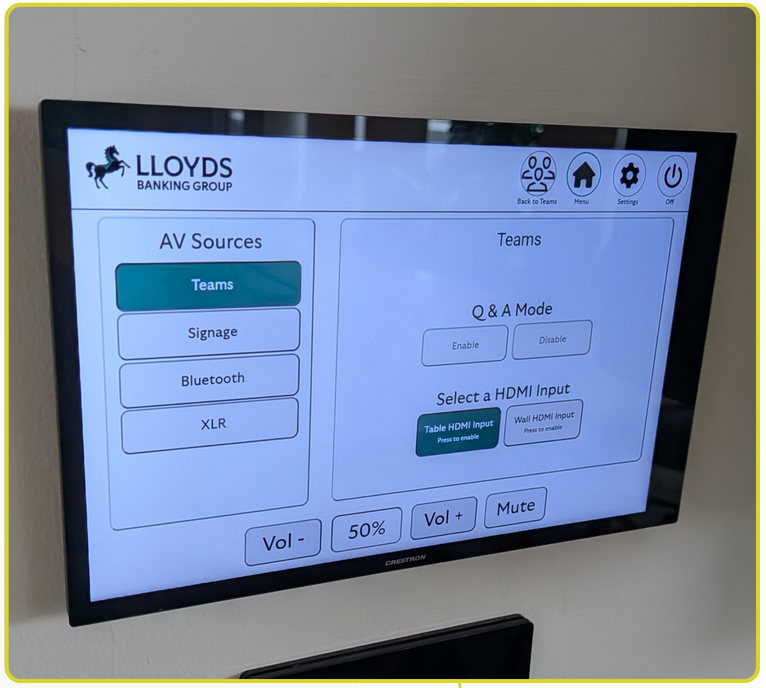
Align
Salesforce + call-centre hand-off

Next
Open Banking opportunity

Events UI Panel Redesign

Transforming AV Controls for colleagues

Steven
Gladman



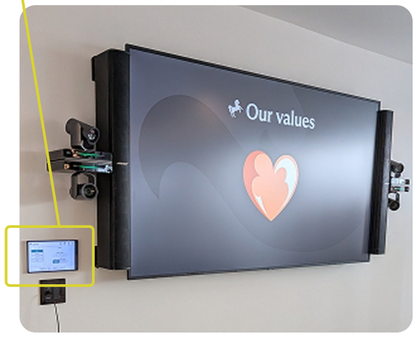
Executive Summary

The Events UI Panel is a touchscreen interface used across the organisation to control AV equipment within event spaces, including microphones, audio, cameras and screens.

Feedback and usability observations showed that the existing experience placed unnecessary cognitive effort on users. Controls lacked clear hierarchy, interaction behaviours were inconsistent and users could struggle to quickly identify the functionality they needed.

A heuristic review highlighted several usability issues:

- **Navigation controls did not always clearly communicate their purpose or behaviour.**
- **Active and inactive states were difficult to distinguish.**
- **The Off control created a confusing journey because users could switch everything off but could not subsequently turn everything back on from the same control.**
- **Volume controls relied on repeated small adjustments instead of a more natural touchscreen interaction such as a slider.**
- **Technical terminology, including "Video Matrix", could create barriers for users unfamiliar with AV terminology.**
- **The homepage lacked a clear title to help users understand where they were within the interface.**
- **Various usability problems only became evident when interacting with the design on a physical touchscreen.**

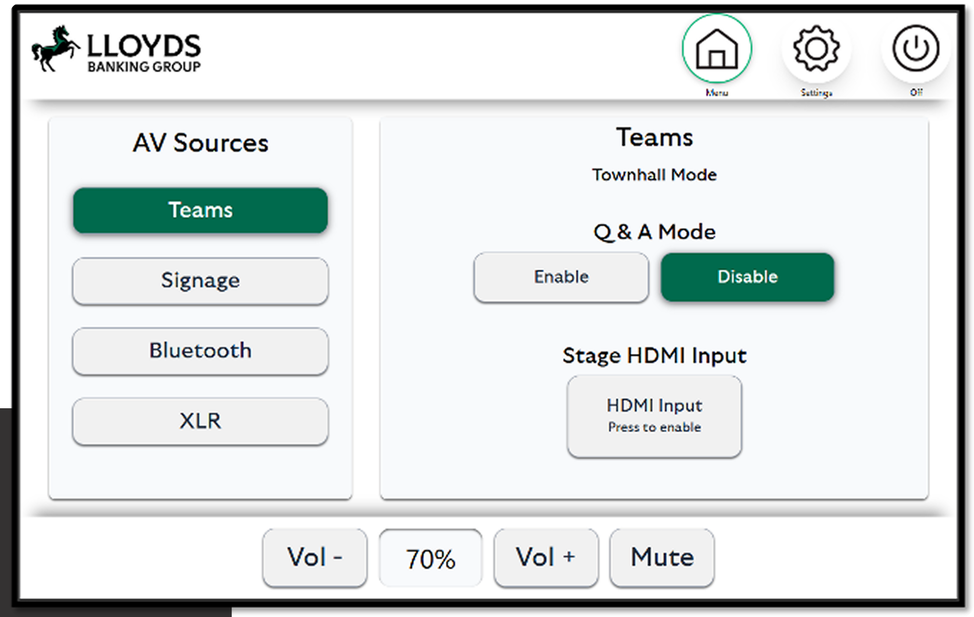


This created an opportunity not simply to refresh the UI, but to **reconsider how users interacted with the AV system.**

Objective

My objective was to **redesign the Events UI Panel around the needs of its users**, making common AV tasks easier to understand and complete while reducing confusion and unnecessary interaction.

As the UX designer, my role covered the design process from **evaluating the existing experience through to wireframing, prototyping, usability testing and supporting development.**



My focus was to:

- **Understand and prioritise usability pain points.**
- **Map journey flows through key AV tasks.**
- **Apply familiar and consistent interaction patterns.**
- **Use creative problem solving to simplify technically complex controls.**
- **Design and test alternative concepts through wireframes and prototypes.**
- **Promote inclusive design, particularly by reducing reliance on technical terminology and making controls easier to understand.**
- **Apply the Cancara design system to bring consistency and organisational standards into the redesigned experience.**
- **Demonstrate the value of UX design within a specialist, technical touchscreen environment.**

Evaluated the existing experience

Core capabilities:

UX Evaluation | Analytical Thinking | Problem Definition | Usability Principles

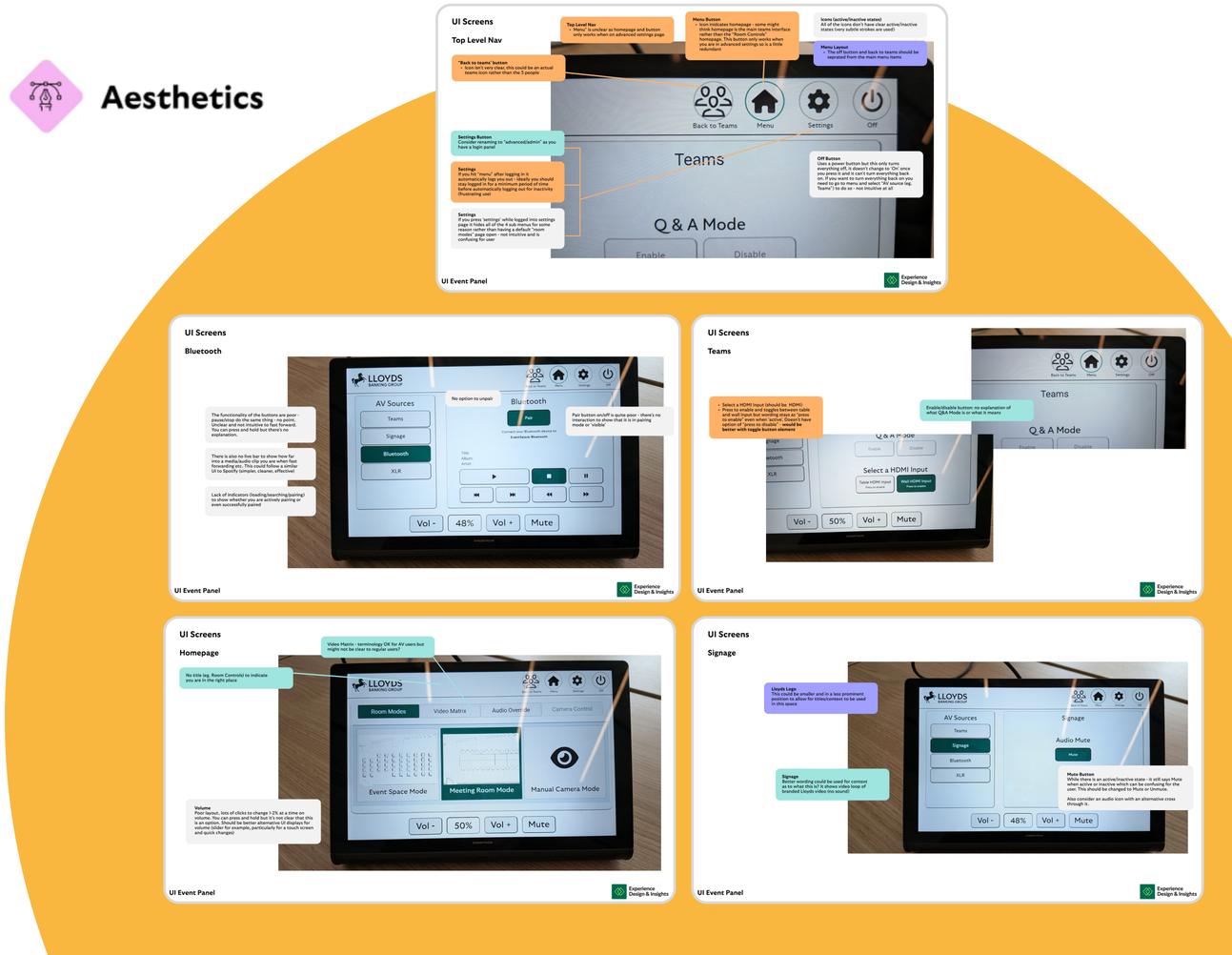
I started by reviewing the existing interface against five UX heuristic categories:

Navigation & Usability | **Interaction** | **Content** | **Layout** | **Aesthetics**

Rather than approaching the redesign as a visual refresh, the heuristic evaluation gave me a structured way of **identifying why individual elements were creating problems for users.**

I used the findings to turn usability issues into actionable design recommendations, helping establish a clear rationale for subsequent design decisions.

This also helped prioritise where design effort could provide the greatest user value, particularly around navigation, control states, terminology and complex AV interactions.



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Explored journeys and alternative solutions

I then explored how the identified issues could be addressed through alternative layouts and interaction approaches.

Using **Figma**, I created multiple **wireframe concepts** rather than moving immediately to a single polished solution. This allowed me to explore different information hierarchies, control layouts and **journey flows** before committing to a direction.

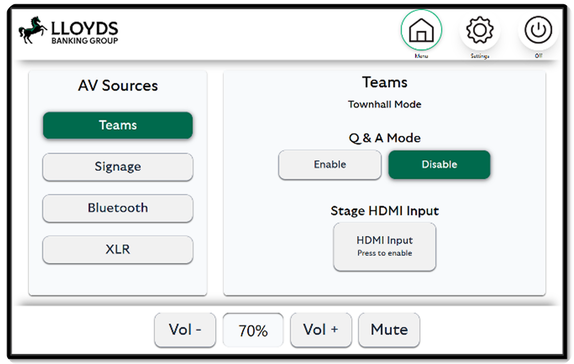
Particular attention was given to how somebody would progress through common tasks and whether the interface provided enough feedback to understand:

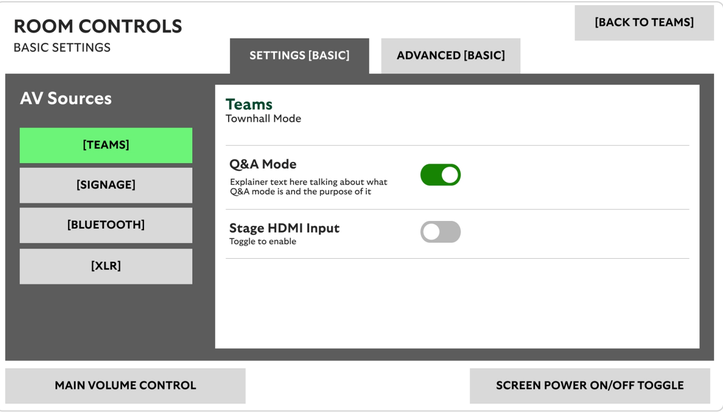
Where am I? → What can I control? → What have I selected? → What happens next?

> This stage involved creative problem solving, balancing the underlying complexity of the AV system with the need to provide users with an interface that felt simple and predictable.
>
> Developers were involved throughout the exploration to ensure proposed interactions were technically feasible.

Core capabilities:

Wireframing | Journey Design | Information Architecture | Creative Problem Solving





Figma

Mockups & Prototypes were created in Figma

Core capabilities:

UX analysis | Heuristic Evaluation | Problem Definition | Stakeholder Collaboration

Tested and iterated the concepts

The alternative wireframes were usability tested against the original interface.

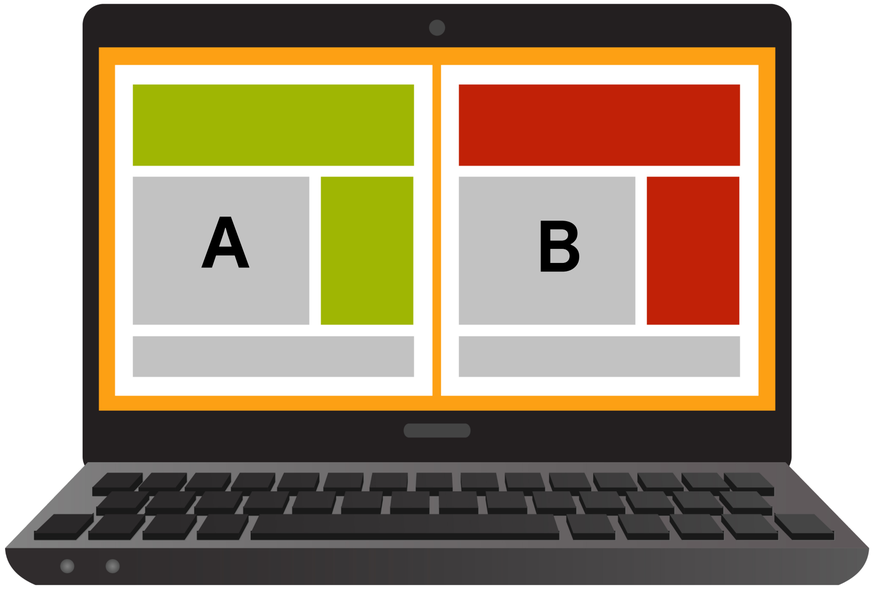
Testing was particularly important because this wasn't simply a desktop interface. The UI would ultimately be operated through a physical touchscreen, meaning interactions that appeared straightforward within a design file did not necessarily feel intuitive when used in context.

This meant the user testing had to be performed in-person to get live feedback and highlight any issues with the interface and the usability of it.

The testing helped identify opportunities to refine the interaction model and provided evidence for progressing the preferred concept.

This created an iterative design cycle of:

Evaluate → Explore → Prototype → Test → Refine



Established clearer interaction patterns

For the next step, I progressed the preferred direction from wireframes into a **high-fidelity interactive prototype.**

A key part of the redesign was introducing clearer, more familiar interaction patterns, including:

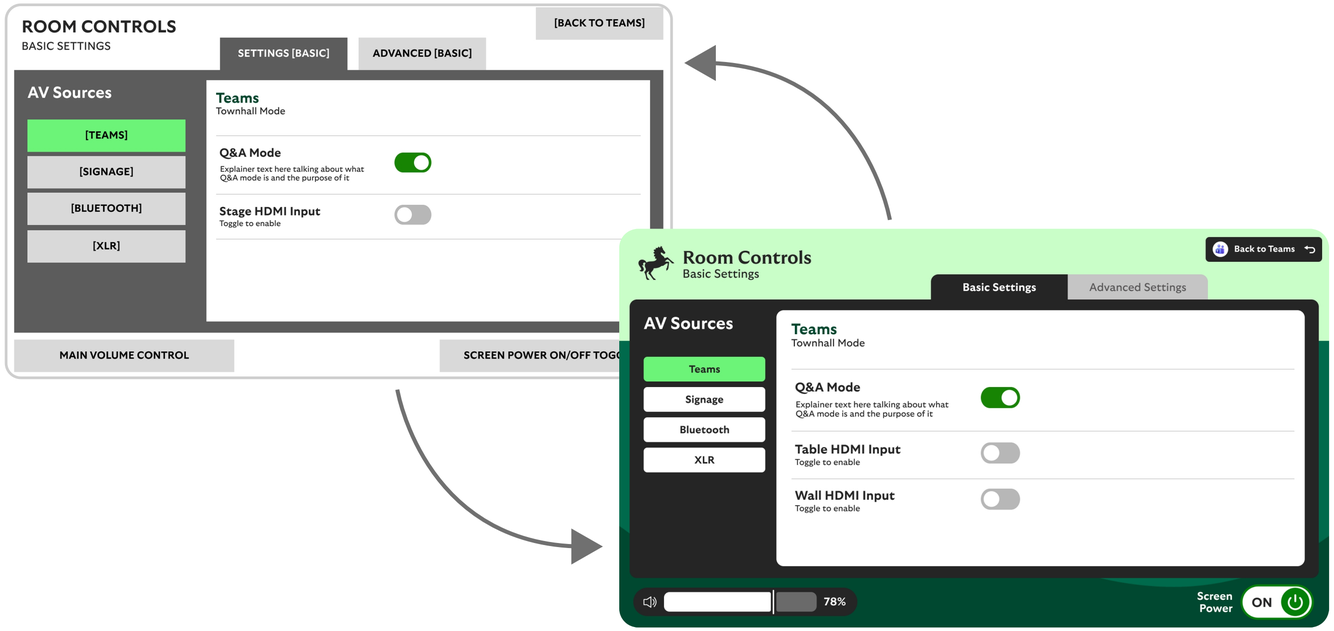
- **Distinct active and inactive states.**
- **Toggle controls for clearer binary choices.**
- **Sliders for touchscreen-friendly adjustment.**
- **Clearer navigation behaviours.**
- **Save and Reset functionality where appropriate.**

These patterns helped make the interface more predictable, allowing users to recognise how controls behaved rather than having to learn individual behaviours throughout the system.

I used the Cancara design system as part of the UI design process, applying established design standards and organisational branding to help create a more consistent experience.

Core capabilities:

Interaction Design | Prototyping | Design Systems | UI Consistency



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Figma

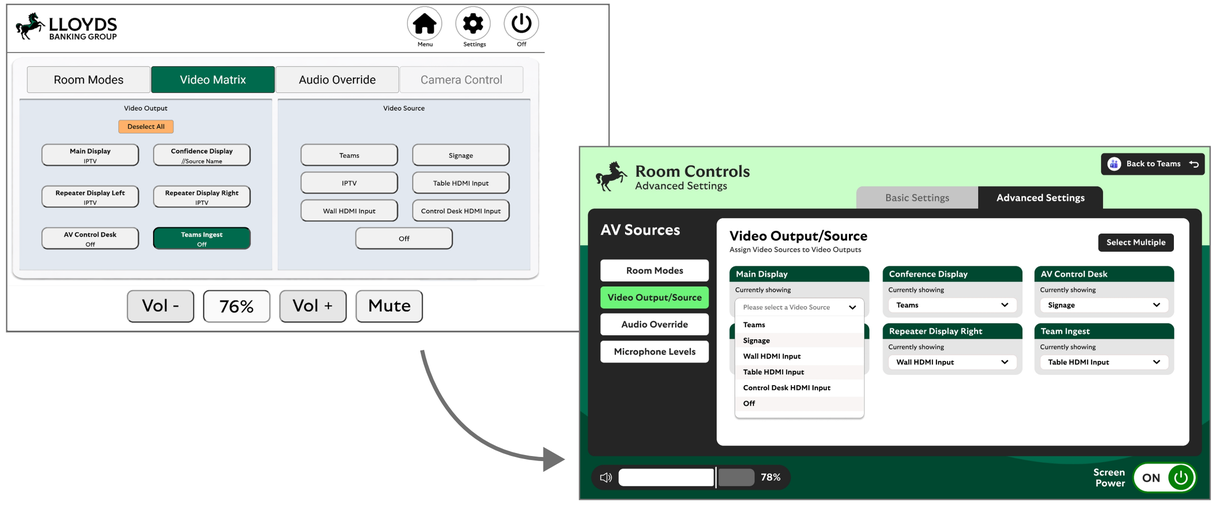
Mockups & Prototypes were created in Figma

Simplified complex AV interactions

One of the biggest design challenges was the Video Matrix, where technically focused functionality needed to be understandable to users who might not be AV specialists.

Rather than expecting the user to understand how the underlying technology worked, I explored how the interface could present those choices using more familiar interaction patterns, clearer terminology and contextual guidance.

The redesigned experience introduced dropdowns and supporting copy to make the relationship between inputs and outputs easier to understand.



Core capabilities:

Interaction Design | Content Design | Journey Simplification | Problem Solving

Camera controls were similarly reorganised into stepped sections, creating a more logical journey through the available functionality rather than presenting every control with equal prominence.

This was an important example of creative problem solving, translating technically complex functionality into a simpler user experience without removing the capabilities users required.

Figma

Mockups & Prototypes were created in Figma

Promoted inclusive design

Inclusive design was considered through the way information and controls were presented.

Rather than assuming users had specialist AV knowledge, I looked for opportunities to reduce that dependency through:

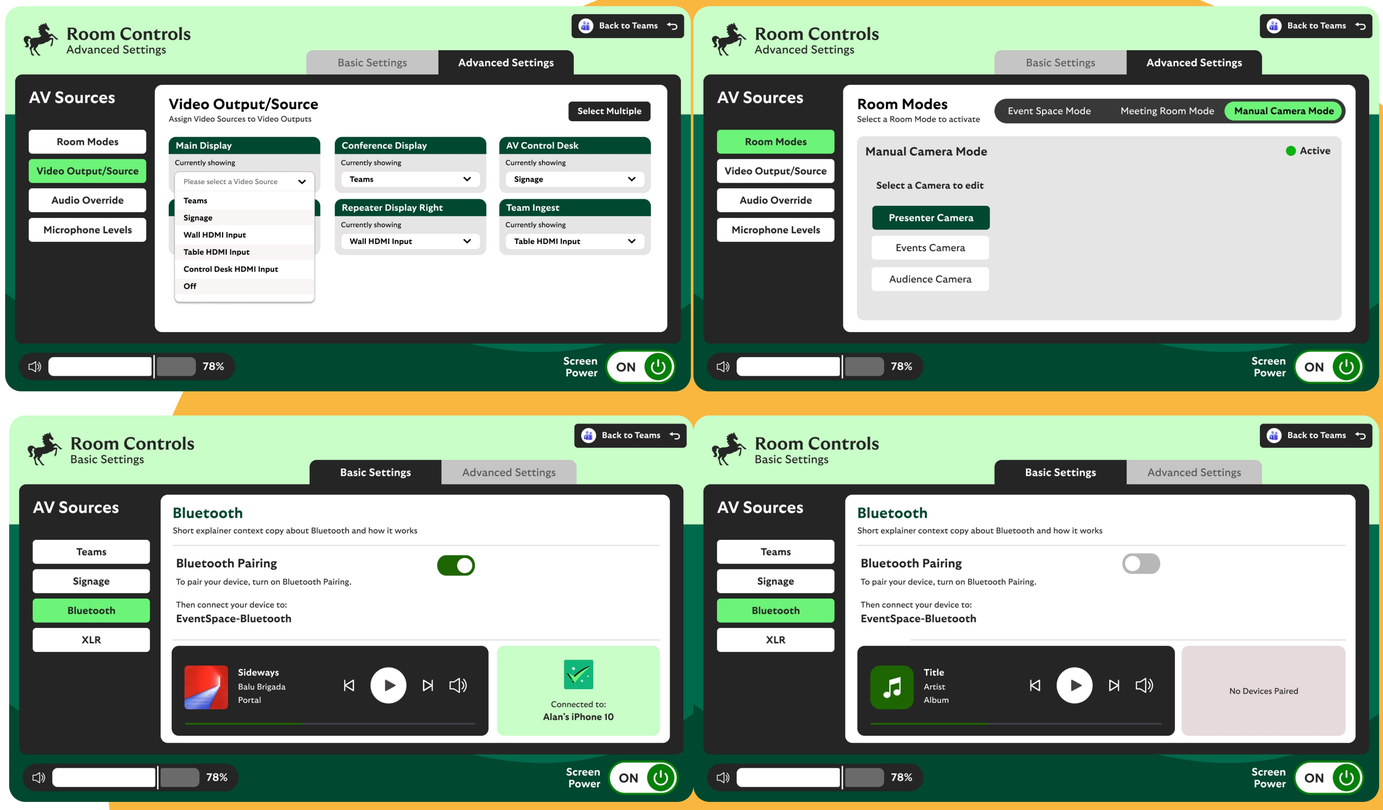
- **Clearer Language**
- **Contextual Explanations**
- **Recognisable Controls**
- **Stronger Information Hierarchy**
- **Clearer System States**
- **Predictable Interaction Patterns.**

The objective was to make the interface **easier to understand regardless of the user's familiarity with AV technology.**

This shifted the experience away from one designed around the technology and towards one **designed around the person trying to accomplish a task.**

Core capabilities:

Inclusive Design | Content Design | Accessibility Thinking | User-Centred Design



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Core capabilities:

Developer Collaboration | Design Handover | Design Quality | Asset Delivery

Worked collaboratively through to development

Once the design had been developed into a prototype, I prepared the design and supporting assets for development.

I worked closely with developers throughout the project, discussing technical feasibility during exploration rather than waiting until handover.

I remained involved as the design progressed into a basic build, helping maintain the UX principles and interaction standards established through the prototype.

Further touchscreen and in-person usability testing was planned as part of the continued iteration of the product.

Result

Initial testing showed **improvements in usability, reduced confusion and frustration, and made key tasks easier to complete.**

A structured evidence base

The project produced a redesigned interactive experience covering key AV functionality including:

- Video Matrix controls
- Camera Controls
- Audio Interactions
- Active/Inactive States
- Toggles
- Sliders
- Save and Reset functionality.

The value of UX

Most importantly, the work demonstrated **the value of applying a structured UX process** to a highly technical workplace product.

By moving from heuristic evaluation through **wireframing, journey exploration, prototyping, testing and development collaboration**, I was able to turn technically complex AV functionality into an experience designed around how people actually interact with it.

The design subsequently progressed into development, with further touchscreen and face-to-face testing planned before wider implementation.

> **“I translated a technically complex AV system into an experience that non-specialist users could understand and confidently interact with.”**

Discover
Heuristic evaluation → identify usability problems

Define
Prioritise pain points → understand journeys and interaction problems

Explore
Creative problem solving → alternative wireframes → journey flows

Design
Cancara design system → interaction patterns → inclusive design

Validate
Prototype → usability testing → iteration

Deliver
Developer collaboration → build → further testing